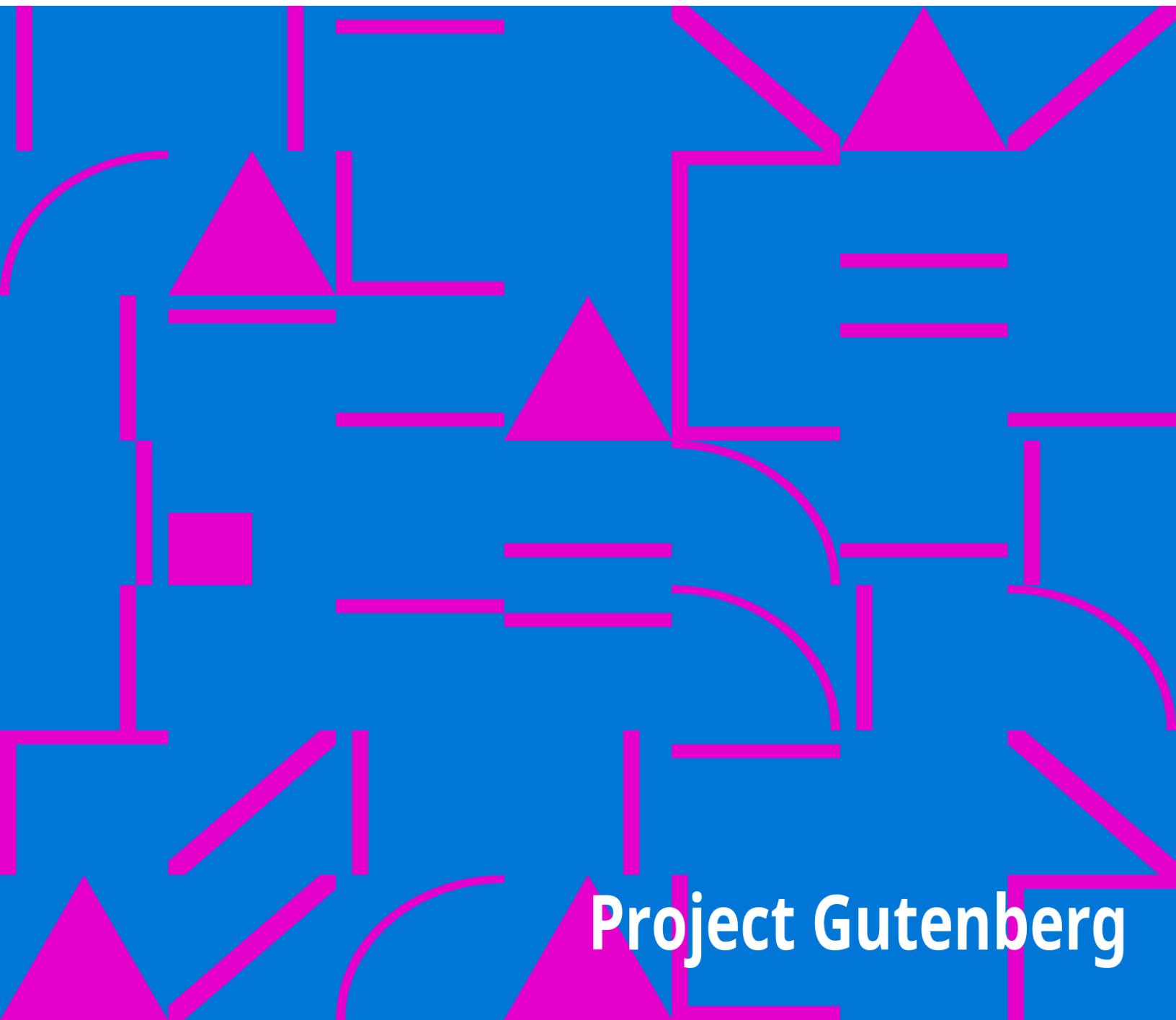


The Manual of Heraldry; Fifth Edition

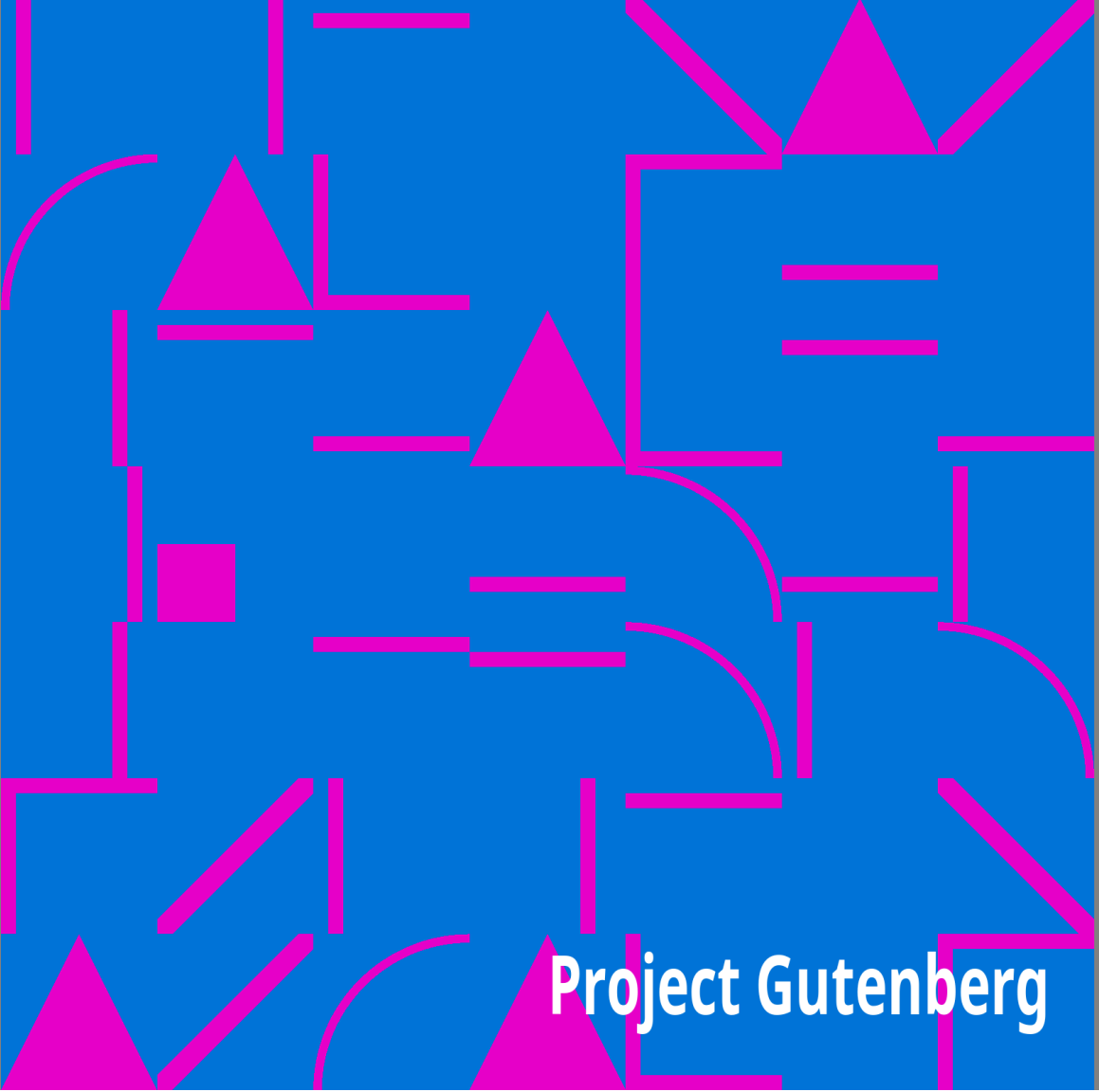
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The background of the lower half of the image is a solid blue field. Overlaid on this field is a repeating pattern of magenta heraldic symbols. These symbols include various geometric shapes such as triangles, squares, and rectangles, as well as curved lines and horizontal bars, arranged in a way that suggests traditional heraldic designs like quarters, crosses, and other charges.

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Release date: July 12, 2005 [eBook #16273]

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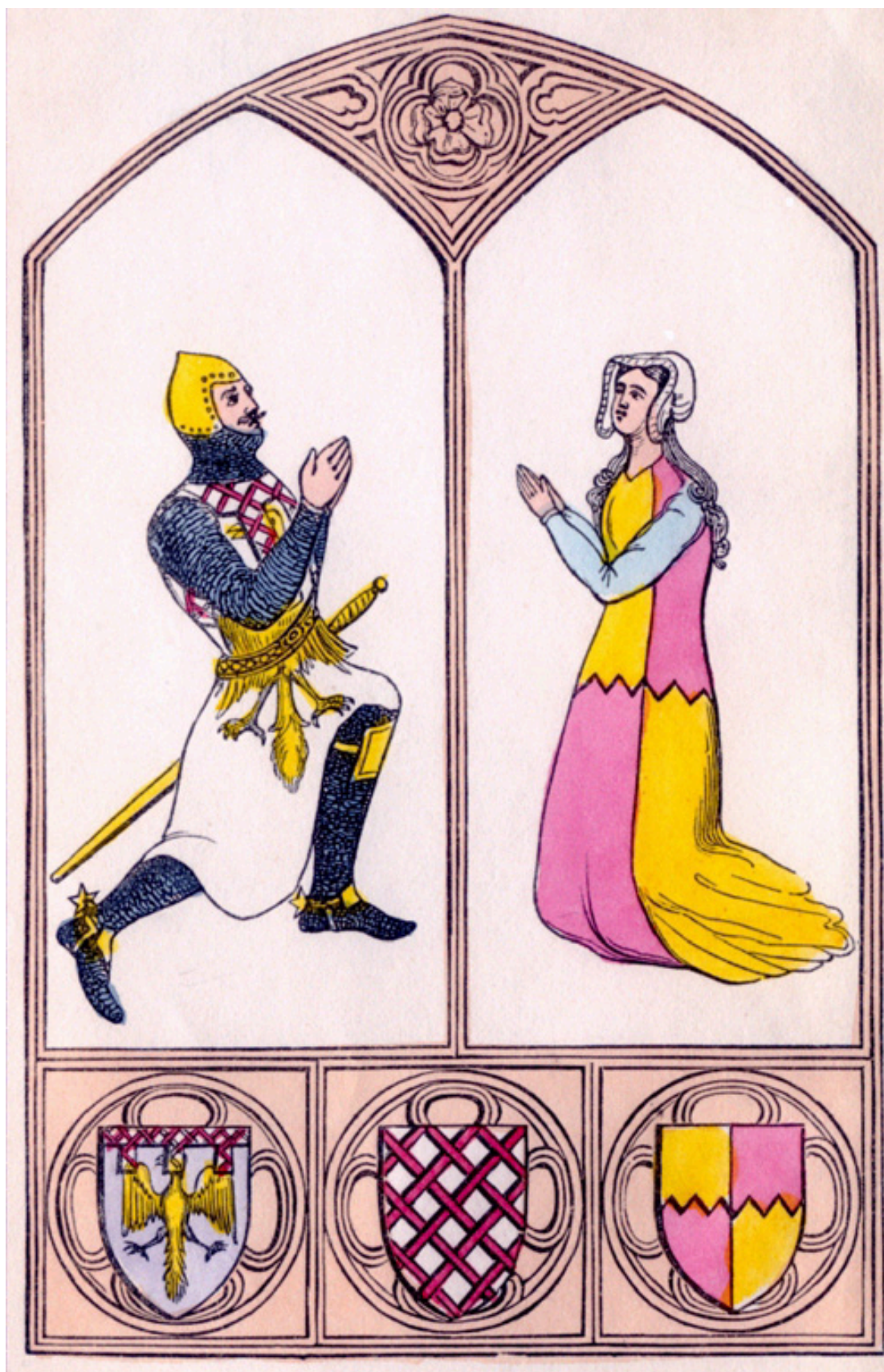
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Transcriber's Note:

The following changes have been made to inconsistent spelling in the original text: Chap. IV.: 'scarpe' for 'scrape'; and, in the dictionary: SEMÉ/semé for SEME/semi.



Frontispiece

See P. 130.

THE

MANUAL OF HERALDRY:

BEING

A CONCISE DESCRIPTION

OF

THE SEVERAL TERMS USED,

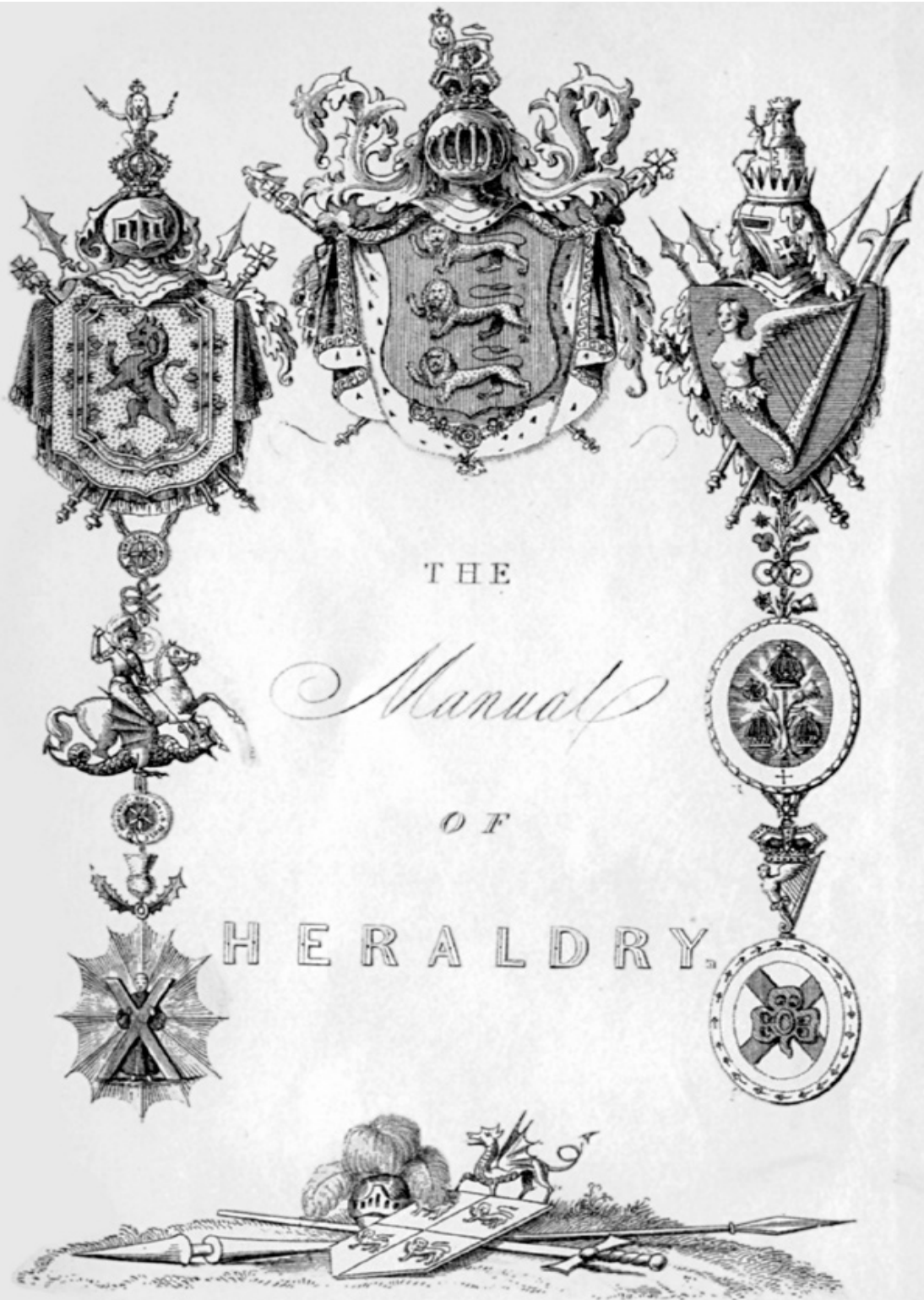
AND CONTAINING

A Dictionary of every Designation in the Science.

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FOUR HUNDRED ENGRAVINGS ON WOOD.

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MANUAL OF HERALDRY.

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**HERALDRY IN CONNECTION WITH HISTORY, ARCHITECTURE, INTERIOR DECORATION,
COSTUME, AMUSEMENT, RELIGIOUS SOLEMNITIES, FUNERAL RITES, ETC.**



CHAPTER I.

ORIGIN OF COATS OF ARMS.

Heraldry is the science which teaches how to blazon or describe in proper terms armorial bearings and their accessories.

Many volumes have been written on the origin of Heraldry and even on the antiquity of separate charges contained in an escutcheon: it would be filling the pages of an elementary work on Heraldry to little purpose to enter upon an inquiry as to the exact period of the introduction of an art that has existed in some degree in all countries whose inhabitants have emerged from barbarism to civilization. In all ages men have made use of figures of living creatures, trees, flowers, and inanimate objects, as symbolical signs to distinguish themselves in war, or denote the bravery and courage of their chief or nation.

The allegorical designs emblazoned on the standards, shields, and armour of the Greeks and Romans—the White Horse of the Saxons, the Raven of the Danes, and the Lion of the Normans, may all be termed heraldic devices; but according to the opinions of Camden, Spelman, and other high authorities, hereditary arms of families were first introduced at the commencement of the twelfth century. When numerous armies engaged in the expeditions to the Holy Land, consisting of the troops of twenty different nations, they were obliged to adopt some ensign or mark in order to marshal the vassals under the banners of the various leaders. The regulation of the symbols whereby the Sovereigns and Lords of Europe should be distinguished, all of whom were ardent in maintaining the honour of the several nations to which they belonged, was a matter of great nicety, and it was properly entrusted to the Heralds who invented signs of honour which could not be construed into offence, and made general regulations for their display on the banners and shields of the chiefs of the different nations. The ornaments and regulations were sanctioned by the sovereigns engaged in the Crusade, and hence the origin of the present system of Heraldry, which prevails with trifling variations in every kingdom of Europe.

The passion for military fame which prevailed at this period led to the introduction of mock battles, called Tournaments. Here the Knights appeared with the Heraldic honours conferred upon them for deeds of prowess in actual battle. All were emulous of such distinctions. The subordinate followers appeared with the distinctive arms of their Lord, with the addition of some mark denoting inferiority. These marks of honour at first were merely pieces of stuff of various colours cut into strips and sewn on the surcoat or garment worn over armour, to protect it from the effect of exposure to the atmosphere. These strips were disposed in various ways, and gave the idea of the chief, bend, chevron, &c. Figures of animals and other objects were gradually introduced; and as none could legally claim or use those honourable distinctions unless they were granted by the Kings of Arms, those Heraldic sovereigns formed a code of laws for the regulation of titles and insignia of honour, which the Sovereigns and

Knights of Europe have bound themselves to protect; and those rules constitute the science of Heraldry which forms the subject of the following pages.



CHAP. II.

VARIOUS SORTS OF ARMS.

Arms are not only granted to individuals and families, but also to cities, corporate bodies, and learned societies. They may therefore be classed as follows:—

**Arms of DOMINION, PRETENSION, CONCESSION.
COMMUNITY, PATRONAGE, FAMILY.
ALLIANCE, AND SUCCESSION.**

Arms of Dominion or Sovereignty are properly the arms of the kings or sovereigns of the territories they govern, which are also regarded as the arms of the State. Thus the Lions of England and the Russian Eagle are the arms of the Kings of England and the Emperors of Russia, and cannot properly be altered by a change of dynasty.

Arms of Pretension are those of kingdoms, provinces, or territories to which a prince or lord has some claim, and which he adds to his own, though the kingdoms or territories are governed by a foreign king or lord: thus the Kings of England for many ages quartered the arms of France in their escutcheon as the descendants of Edward III., who claimed that kingdom, in right of his mother, a French princess.

Arms of Concession are arms granted by sovereigns as the reward of virtue, valour, or extraordinary service. All arms granted to subjects were originally conceded by the Sovereign.

Arms of Community are those of bishoprics, cities, universities, academies, societies, and corporate bodies.

Arms of Patronage are such as governors of provinces, lords of manors, add to their family arms as a token of their superiority, right, and jurisdiction.

Arms of Family, or paternal arms, are such as are hereditary and belong to one particular family, which none others have a right to assume, nor can they do so without rendering themselves guilty of a breach of the laws of honour punishable by the Earl Marshal and the Kings at Arms. The assumption of arms has however become so common that little notice is taken of it at the present time.

Arms of Alliance are those gained by marriage.

Arms of Succession are such as are taken up by those who inherit certain estates by bequest, entail, or donation.

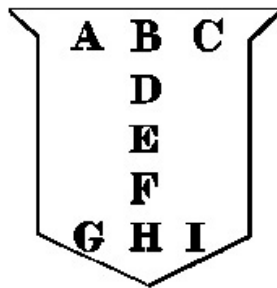
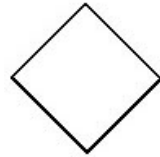
SHIELDS, TINCTURES, FURS, &c.

The **Shield** contains the field or ground whereon are represented the charges or figures that form a coat of arms. These were painted on the shield before they were placed on banners, standards, and coat armour; and wherever they appear at the present time they are painted on a plane or superficies resembling a shield.

Shields in Heraldic language are called Escutcheons or Scutcheons, from the Latin word **scutum**. The forms of the shield or field upon which arms are emblazoned are varied according to the taste of the painter. The Norman pointed shield is generally used in Heraldic



paintings in ecclesiastical buildings: the escutcheons of maiden ladies and widows are painted on a lozenge-shaped shield. Armorists distinguish several points in the escutcheon in order to determine exactly the position of the bearings or charges. They are denoted in the annexed diagram, by the first nine letters of the alphabet ranged in the following manner:



- A, the dexter chief.
- B, the precise middle chief.
- C, the sinister chief.
- D, the honour point.
- E, the fess point.
- F, the nombril point.
- G, the dexter base.
- H, the precise middle base.

I, the sinister base.

The dexter side of the escutcheon answers to the left hand, and the sinister side to the right hand of the person that looks at it.

TINCTURES.

By the term **Tincture** is meant that variable hue which is given to shields and their bearings; they are divided into colours and furs.

The colours or metals used in emblazoning arms are—

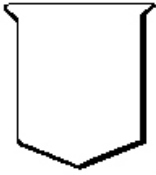
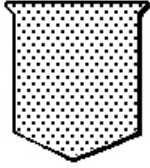
yellow,
white,
red,

blue,
black,
green,

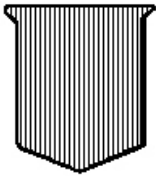
purple,
orange,
murrey.

These colours are denoted in engravings by various lines or dots, as follows:

OR, which signifies **gold**, and in colour yellow, is expressed by dots.



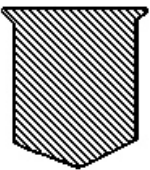
ARGENT signifies *silver* or *white*: it is left quite plain.



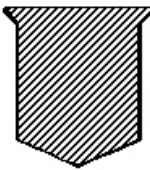
GULES signifies *red*: it is expressed by lines drawn from the chief to the base of the shield.



AZURE signifies *blue*: it is represented by lines drawn from the dexter to the sinister side of the shield, parallel to the chief.

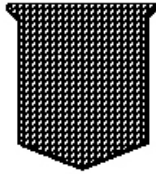
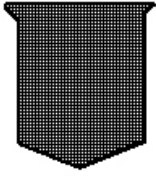


VERT signifies *green*: it is represented by slanting lines, drawn from the dexter to the sinister side of the shield.

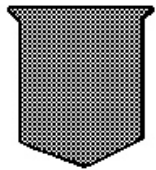


PURPURE, or *purple*, is expressed by diagonal lines, drawn from the sinister to the dexter side of the shield.

SABLE, or *black*, is expressed by horizontal and perpendicular lines crossing each other.

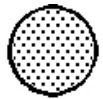


TENNE, which is *tawny*, or *orange* colour, is marked by diagonal lines drawn from the sinister to the dexter side of the shield, traversed by perpendicular lines from the chief.

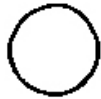


SANGUINE is *dark red*, or *murrey* colour; it is represented by diagonal lines crossing each other.

In addition to the foregoing tinctures, there are nine roundlets or balls used in Armory, the names of which are sufficient to denote their colour without expressing the same.



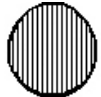
BEZANT, *Or*.



PLATE, *Argent*.



HURTS, *Azure*.



TORTEAUX, *Gules*.



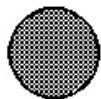
GOLPE, *Purpure*.



PELLET, *Sable*.



ORANGE, *Tenne*.



GUZES, *Sanguine*.



POMEIS, *Vert*.

FURS.

Furs are used to ornament garments of state and denote dignity: ther are used in Heraldry, not only for the lining of mantles and other ornaments of the shield, but also as bearings on escutcheons.

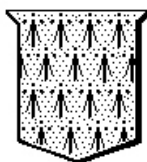
WHITE, represented by a plain shield, like argent.



ERMINE—white powdered with black tufts.



ERMINES—field sable, powdering argent.



ERMINOIS—field or, powdering sable.



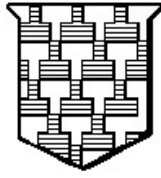
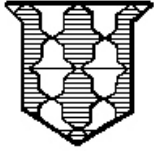
PEAN—field sable; powdering or.

ERMYNITES—Argent, powdered sable, with the addition of a single red hair on each side the sable tufts. This fur is seldom seen in English heraldry; and it is impossible to give an example without using colour.



VAIR—argent and azure. It is represented by small bells, part reversed, ranged in lines in such a manner, that the base argent is opposite to the base azure.

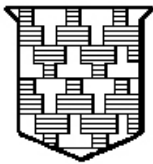
COUNTER-VAIR, is when the bells are placed base against base, and point against point.



POTENT—an obsolete word for a crutch: it is so called in Chaucer's description of Old Age.

"So eld she was that she ne went
A foote, but it were by potent."

The field is filled with small potents, ranged in lines, azure and argent.



POTENT COUNTER-POTENT.

The heads of the crutches or potents touch each other in the centre of the shield.

CHAP. III.

LINES USED IN PARTING THE FIELD.

Escutcheons that have more than one tincture are divided by lines; the straight lines are either perpendicular |, horizontal —, diagonal line dexter \, and diagonal line sinister /.

Curved and angular lines are numerous, and each has an Heraldic name expressive of its form. The names and figures of those most commonly used by English armorists are as follow:
—

railed



ected



vy, or undé



battled, or crenelle



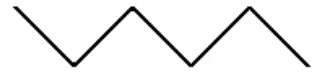
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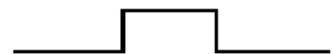
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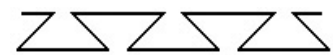
artelle



vy, or franché



re-tailed



battled grady:
ometimes called
iled embattled



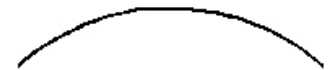
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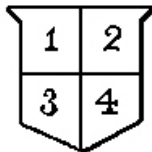
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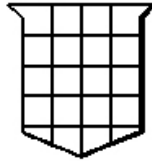


If a shield is divided into four equal parts, it is said to be quartered: this may be done two ways, viz.—



QUARTERED PER CROSS—The shield is divided into four parts, called quarters, by an horizontal and perpendicular line, crossing each other in the centre of the field, each of which is numbered.

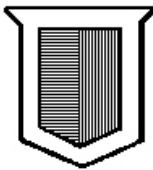
QUARTERED PER SALTIER, which is made by two diagonal lines, dexter and sinister, crossing each other in the centre of the field.



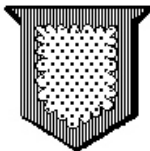
The Escutcheon is sometimes divided into a great number of parts, in order to place in it the arms of several families to which one is allied; this is called a genealogical achievement. The compartments are called **QUARTERINGS**.

DIFFERENCES.

All members of the same family claim the same bearings in their coats of arms; and to distinguish the principal bearer from his descendants or relatives, it was necessary to invent some sign so that the degree of consanguinity might be known. These signs are called **DIFFERENCES**. During the Crusades, the only difference consisted in the bordure or border, which, as the name implies, was a border or edging running round the edge of the shield. The colour and form of this border served to distinguish the leaders of the different bands that served under one duke or chieftain. The same difference might be used to denote a diversity between particular persons descended from one family. At the present time they are not used to



denote a difference, but as one of the ordinaries to a coat of arms. The annexed example exhibits the arms of the Monastery of Bermondsey. **Party per pale, azure and gules; a bordure, argent.** This bordure is plain; but they may be formed by any of the foregoing lines.



The annexed example is **or, a bordure engrailed, gules.**

The differences used by armorists at the present time are nine in number. They not only distinguish the sons of one family, but also denote the subordinate degrees in each house.

The Heir, or first son, the LABEL

Second Son, the CRESCENT



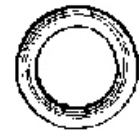
Third Son, the MULLET



Fourth Son, the MARTLET



Fifth Son, the ANNULET



Sixth Son, the FLEUR-DE-LIS



Seventh Son, the ROSE



Eighth Son, the CROSS MOLINE



Ninth Son, the DOUBLE QUATREFOIL



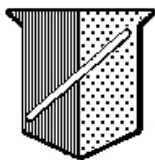
Should either of the nine brothers have male children, the eldest child would place the label on the difference that distinguished his father; the second son would place the crescent upon it; the third the mullet; continuing the same order for as many sons as he may have.

The label only, is used in the arms of the royal family as a difference; but the points of the label are charged with different figures to distinguish the second and succeeding sons. The arms of the sons of King George III. were thus distinguished: the shield of the arms of the Prince of Wales by a label; the Duke of York's by the label, the center point of which was charged with a red cross; that of the Duke of Clarence by a label, the dexter and sinister points of which were charged with an anchor, the center point with the red cross; each of the succeeding sons were differenced by charges on the points of the labels.

All the figures denoting differences are also used as perfect charges on the shield; but their size and situation will sufficiently determine whether the figure is used as a perfect coat of arms, or is introduced as a difference or dimunition.

Sisters have no differences in their coats of arms. They are permitted to bear the arms of their father, as the eldest son does after his father's decease.

Guillim, Leigh, and other ancient armorists mention divers figures, which, they assert, were formerly added to coats of arms as marks of degradation for slander, cowardice, murder, and other crimes, and to them they give the name of abatements of honour; others have called them blots in the escutcheon: but as no instance can be produced of such dishonourable marks having been borne in a coat of arms, they may justly be considered as chimerical, or at any rate obsolete, and unworthy of consideration at the present time. Porney pithily observes, "that arms being marks of honour, they cannot admit of any note of infamy, nor would any one bear them if they were so branded. It is true, a man may be degraded for divers crimes, particularly high treason; but in such cases the escutcheon is reversed, trod upon, and torn in pieces, to denote a total extinction and suppression of the honour and dignity of the person to whom it belonged."



The only abatement used in heraldry is the **baton**: this denotes illegitimacy. It is borne in the escutcheons of the dukes that assume the royal arms as the illegitimate descendants of King Charles the Second.

CHAP. IV.

HONOURABLE ORDINARIES.

Honourable ordinaries are the original marks of distinction bestowed by sovereigns on subjects that have become eminent for their services, either in the council or the field of battle. Volumes have been written upon the origin and form of the honourable ordinaries. These long and tedious inquiries can only be interesting to antiquaries: it is sufficient for the tyro in heraldry to know that they are merely broad lines or bands of various colours, which have different names, according to the place they occupy in the shield; ancient armorists admit but nine honourable ordinaries—the chief, the pale, the bend, the bend sinister, the fess, the bar, the chevron, the cross, and the saltier.

The **chief** is an ordinary terminated by an horizontal line, which, if it is of any other form but straight, its form must be expressed; it is placed in the upper part of the escutcheon, and occupies one third of the field.



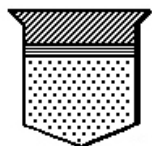
Ex. **Argent, on a chief, gules, two mullets, sable.**

Any of the lines before described may be used to form the chief.



Ex. **Argent, a chief, azure, indented.**

The chief has a diminutive called a **fillet**; it must never be more than one fourth the breadth of the chief.

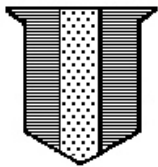


Ex. **Or, a chief, purpure, in the lower part a fillet, azure.**

This ordinary may be charged with a variety of figures, which are always named after the tincture of the chief.

It may be necessary to inform the reader that, in describing a coat of arms, the general colour of the shield or the field is first described, then the honourable ordinaries, their tinctures, then the object with which they are charged. We shall have to remark more particularly on the order of describing ordinaries, tinctures, and charges on coats of arms, when we treat of the rules of heraldry; but the student might have been confused if this brief direction had been omitted, as we shall have to describe every shield of arms in the same order.

The **pale** is an honourable ordinary, consisting of two perpendicular lines drawn from the top to the base of the escutcheon, and contains one third of the width of the field.



Ex. **Azure, a pale, or.**

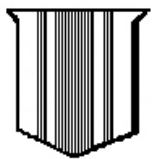
The pale may be formed of any of the lines before described; it is then called a **pale engrailed, a pale dancette, &c.**

The pale has a diminutive called the **pallet**, which is one half the width of the pale.



Ex. **Argent, a pallet, gules.**

The pale has another diminutive one fourth its size; it is called an **endorse**.

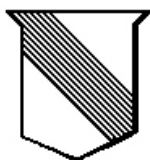


Ex. **Argent, a pale between two endorses, gules.**

The pale and the pallet may receive any charge; but the endorse is never to be charged with any thing.

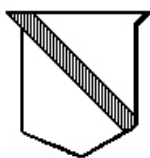
THE BEND.

The ***bend*** is an honourable ordinary, formed by two diagonal lines drawn from the dexter chief to the sinister base, and contains the fifth part of the field if uncharged; but if charged with other figures, the third part of the field.



Ex. **Argent, a bend, vert.**

The bend has four diminutives, viz. the ***garter*** which is half the breadth of the bend.



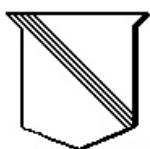
Ex. **Argent, a garter, gules.**

The ***cotice*** which is the fourth part of the bend. Cotices generally accompany the bend in pairs; thus a bend between two cotices is said to be cotised.

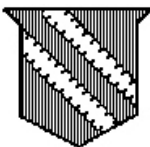


Ex. **Gules, a bend, argent, coticed of the same.**

The ***riband***, which is one third less than the garter and the ***bendlet***, must never occupy more than one sixth of the field.



Ex. **Argent, a riband vert.**



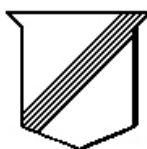
Ex. **Gules, two bendlets, engrailed, argent.**

The ***bend sinister*** is the same breadth as the bend dexter, and is drawn from the sinister to the dexter side of the shield.



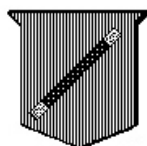
Ex. **Argent, a bend sinister, purpure.**

The ***scarpe*** is the diminutive of the bend sinister, and is half its size.



Ex. **Argent, a scarpe, purpure.**

The ***baton*** is the fourth part of the bend, and, as before mentioned, it is a mark of illegitimacy, and seldom used in Heraldry, but by the illegitimate descendants of royalty.



Ex. **Gules, a baton, sable, garnished, or.**

THE FESS AND BAR.

The ***fess*** is formed by two horizontal lines drawn above and below the centre of the shield. The fess contains in breadth one third of the field.



Ex. **Argent, a fess, azure.**

The ***bar*** is formed in the same manner as the fess, but it only occupies the fifth part of the field. It differs from the fess, that ordinary being always placed in the centre of the field; but the bar may be placed in any part of it, and there may be more than one bar in an escutcheon.

Ex. **Gules, two bars, argent.**

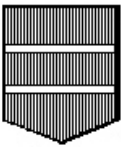


The **closet** is a diminutive of the bar, and is half its width.



Ex. **Argent, two closets, azure.**

The **barrulet** is half the width of the closet.



Ex. **Gules, two barrulets, argent.**

The annexed example is to illustrate the word **gemels**, which is frequently used to describe double bars. The word **gemels** is a corruption of the French word **jumelles**, which signifies double.



Ex. **Azure, two bars, gemels, argent.**

When the shield contains a number of bars of metal and colour alternate, exceeding five, it is called **barry** of so many pieces, expressing their numbers.



Ex. **Barry of seven pieces, argent and azure.**

THE CHEVRON.

The figure of the ***chevron*** has been described as representing the gable of a roof. It is a very ancient ordinary, and the less it is charged with other figures the more ancient and honourable it appears.



Ex. **Argent, a chevron, gules.**

The diminutives of the chevron, according to English Heraldry, are the ***chevronel***, which is half the breadth of the chevron.



Ex. **Argent, two chevronels, gules.**

And the ***couple-close***, which is half the chevronel.



Ex. **Gules, three couple-closes interlaced in base, or.**

Braced is sometimes used for interlaced. See the word **BRACED** in the Dictionary.

THE CROSS.

This, as its name imports, was the distinguishing badge of the Crusaders, in its simplest form. It was merely two pieces of list or riband of the same length, crossing each other at right angles. The colour of the riband or list denoted the nation to which the Crusader belonged. The cross is an honourable ordinary, occupying one fifth of the shield when not charged, but if charged, one third.

Ex. **Or, a cross, gules.**

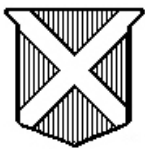


When the cross became the distinguishing badge of different leaders in the Crusades, the simple form given in the preceding example was not generally adopted. Some bordered the red list with a narrow white edge, others terminated the arms of the cross with short pieces of the same colour, placed transversely, making each arm of the cross have the appearance of a short crutch; the ends of these crutches meeting in a point, make the cross potent. There is so great a variety of crosses used in Heraldry that it would be impossible to describe them within the limits of this introduction to Heraldry. The reader will find a great number of those most used in English Heraldry described and illustrated in the Dictionary. He of course will understand, if a coat of arms comes under his notice where this ordinary is described as a cross engrailed, a cross invected, that the form of the cross is the same as that in the last example, but that the lines forming it are engrailed, invected, &c. Small crosses borne as charges are called crosslets.

See the words CROSS, CROSSLETS, in the Dictionary.

THE SALTIER.

The ***saltier*** was formed by making two pieces of riband cross diagonally, having the appearance of the letter X, or, speaking heraldically, the bend and bend sinister crossing each other in the centre of the shield. The saltier, if uncharged, occupies one-fifth of the field; if charged, one-third.



Ex. **Gules, a saltier, argent.**

Like the cross, the saltier may be borne engrailed, wavy, and the termination of the arms of the saltier varied; but there are not so many examples of the variation of the form in the saltier as in the cross.



CHAP. V.

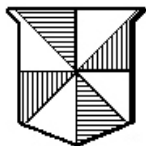
SUBORDINATE ORDINARIES.

In order more particularly to distinguish the subordinates in an army (the chieftains of different countries alone being entitled to the preceding marks of honour), other figures were invented by ancient armorists, and by them termed subordinate ordinaries. Their names and forms are as follows:—



The **gyron** is a triangular figure formed by drawing a line from the dexter angle of the chief of the shield to the fess point, and an horizontal line from that point to the dexter side of the shield.

The field is said to be **gyrony** when it is covered with gyrons.



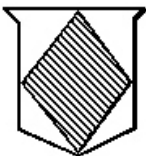
Ex. **Gyrony of eight pieces, argent and gules.**



The **canton** is a square part of the escutcheon, usually occupying about one-eighth of the field; it is placed over the chief at the dexter side of the shield: it may be charged, and when this is the case, its size may be increased. The canton represents the banner of the ancient Knights Banneret. The canton in the example is marked A.

See **KNIGHTS BANNERET** in the Dictionary.

The **lozenge** is formed by four equal and parallel lines but not rectangular, two of its opposite angles being acute, and two obtuse.



Ex. **Argent, a lozenge, vert.**

The **fusil** is narrower than the lozenge, the angles at the chief and base being more acute, and the others more obtuse.



Ex. **Argent, a fusil, purple.**

The **mascle** is in the shape of a lozenge but perforated through its whole extent except a narrow border.



Ex. **Gules, a mascle, argent.**

The **fret** is formed by two lines interlaced in saltier with a mascle.



Ex. **Azure, a fret, argent.**

Fretty is when the shield is covered with lines crossing each other diagonally and interlaced.



Ex. **Gules, fretty of ten pieces, argent.**

At the present time it is not usual to name the number of pieces, but merely the word fretty.

The **pile** is formed like a wedge, and may be borne wavy, engrailed, &c.; it issues generally from the chief, and extends towards the base, but it may be borne in bend or issue from the base.

See **PILE** and **IN PILE** in Dictionary.

Ex. **Argent, a pile, azure.**



The ***inescutcheon*** is a small escutcheon borne within the shield.



Ex. **Argent, a pale, gules, over all an inescutcheon or, a mullet sable.**

An ***orle*** is a perforated inescutcheon, and usually takes the shape of the shield whereon it is placed.



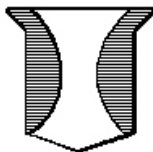
Ex. **Azure, an orle, argent.**

The ***flanche*** is formed by two curved lines nearly touching each other in the centre of the shield.



Ex. **Azure, a flanche, argent.**

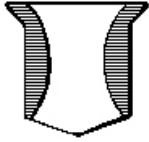
In the ***flasque*** the curved lines do not approach so near each other.



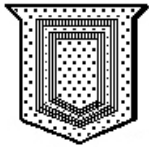
Ex. **Azure, a flasque, argent.**

In the ***voider*** the lines are still wider apart; this ordinary occupies nearly the whole of the field: it may be charged.

Ex. **Azure, a voider, argent.**

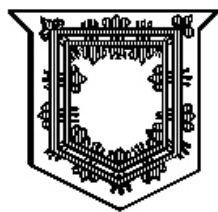


The **tressure** is a border at some distance from the edge of the field, half the breadth of an orle: the tressure may be double or treble.



Ex. **Or, a double tressure, gules.**

Tressures are generally ornamented, or borne flory or counter flory as in the annexed example.



Ex. **Argent, a double tressure, flory and counter-flory, gules.**

CHARGES BORNE IN COATS OF ARMS.

At first when the Feudal System prevailed, not only in England, but other parts of Europe, none but military chieftains bore Coats of Arms. And as few persons held land under the Crown but by military tenure, that is, under the obligation of attending in person with a certain number of vassals and retainers when their services were required by the king for the defence of the state, heraldic honours were confined to the nobility, who were the great landholders of the kingdom. When they granted any portion of their territory to their knights and followers as rewards for deeds of prowess in the field or other services, the new possessors of the land retained the arms of their patrons with a slight difference to denote their subordinate degree. The ingenuity of the armorist was not then taxed to find a multitude of devices to distinguish every family. And when chivalry became the prevailing pursuit of all that sought honour and distinction by deeds of arms and gallant courtesy, the knights assumed the privilege that warriors in all ages have used; viz. that of choosing any device they pleased to ornament the crests of their helmets in the field of battle, or in the mock combat of the tournament: the knight was known and named from the device used as his crest. Thus the heralds, in introducing him to the judges of the field, or to the lady that bestowed the prizes, called him

the Knight of the Swan, the Knight of the Lion, without mentioning any other title. And knights whose fame for gallantry and prowess was firmly established, had their crests painted over their coats of arms. In two or three generations the bearer of the arms established his right to a new crest, and the heralds, to preserve the memory of the ancient honour of the family, introduced the old crest into the coat of arms, either as a charge upon the principal ordinary, or on an unoccupied part of the field. This will in some measure account for the variety of animals and parts of animals found in shields of arms. When the sovereigns of Europe, to decrease the power of the great barons, bestowed estates and titles not only for deeds of arms, but wisdom in council, superior learning, and other qualities which the original bearers of arms thought beneath their notice, the heralds were obliged to invent new symbols in emblazoning the arms of the modern nobility; and when arms were granted to civic and commercial corporations, and to private individuals who had no claim to military honours, we can easily conceive that the ingenuity of the armorists was severely tested, and excuse the apparent confusion that prevailed in granting arms after the War of the Roses. Sir William Dugdale, in his treatise entitled "Ancient Usage in bearing Arms", states that, "Many errors have been and are still committed in granting coats of arms to such persons as have not advanced themselves by the sword, being such as rise by their judgment or skill in arts, affairs, and trades"; with good reason affirming that the latter should however only be allowed "notes or marks of honour fit for their calling, and to show forth the manner of their rising, and not be set off with those representations which in their nature are only proper for martial men."

It would be utterly impossible to give either a graphic or written description of all the charges in a book of this size or even in one ten times as large. The sun, moon, stars, comets, meteors, have been introduced to denote glory, grandeur, power, &c.; lions, leopards, tigers, serpents, stags, have been employed to signify courage, strength, prudence, swiftness, &c.

The application to certain exercises, such as war, hunting, music, fishing, has furnished lances, swords, armour, musical instruments, architecture, columns, chevrons, builders' tools, &c. Human bodies, or distinct parts of them, are frequently used as charges. Trees, plants, fruits, and flowers have also been admitted to denote the rarities, advantages, and singularities of different countries.

The relation of some creatures, figures, &c. to particular names has been a fruitful source for variety of arms. Thus, the family of Coningsby bears three conies; of Arundel, six swallows; of Corbet, a raven; of Urson, a bear; of Camel, a camel; of Starky, a stork; of Castleman, a castle triple-towered; of Shuttleworth, three weaver's shuttles. Hundreds of other names might be given, but the before-mentioned will be sufficient to show the reader the origin of many singular charges in coats of arms.

Not only were natural and artificial figures used, but the lack of information on Zoology and other branches of Natural History led to the introduction of fabulous animals, such as dragons, griffins, harpies, wiverns, &c. A great number of charges, indeed most of them that require explanation, will be found in the Dictionary of Heraldic Terms, which will prevent the necessity of describing them more at large in this part of the book.

THE EXTERNAL ORNAMENTS OF ESCUTCHEONS.

The ornaments that accompany or surround escutcheons were introduced to denote the birth, dignity, or office of the person to whom the coat of arms belongs. We shall merely give the names of the various objects in this place, and refer the reader to the different words in the Dictionary. Over regal escutcheons are placed the crown which pertains to the nation over which the sovereign presides. The crown is generally surmounted with a crest: as in the arms of the kings of England, the crown is surmounted by a lion statant, guardant, crowned.

Over the Papal arms is placed a tiara or triple crown, without a crest.

Above the arms of archbishops and bishops the mitre is placed instead of a crest.

Coronets are worn by all princes and peers. They vary in form according to the rank of the nobleman. A full description will be found in the Dictionary of the coronets of the prince of Wales, royal dukes, dukes, marquises, earls, viscounts, and barons.

Helmets are placed over arms, and show the rank of the person to whom the arms belong: 1st, by the metal of which they are made; 2dly, by their form; 3dly, by their position. See the word **HELMET** in the Dictionary.

Mantlings were the ancient coverings of helmets to preserve them and the bearers from the injuries of the weather. It is probable that they were highly ornamented with scroll-work of gold and silver, and their borders or edges cast into fanciful shapes. They are now formed into scroll-work proceeding from the sides of the helmet, and are great ornaments to an escutcheon. See a more full description under the word **MANTLING**.

CHAPEAUX.

A **chapeau** is an ancient hat or rather cap of dignity worn by dukes. They were formed of scarlet velvet and turned up with fur. They are frequently used instead of a wreath under the crests of noblemen and even gentlemen.

The wreath was formed by two large skeins of silk of different colours twisted together. This was worn at the lower part of the crest, not alone as an ornament, but to protect the head from the blow of a mace or sword. In Heraldry the wreath appears like a straight line or roll of two colours generally the same as the tinctures of the shield. The crest is usually placed upon the wreath.

The crest is the highest part among the ornaments of a coat of arms. It is called crest from the Latin word **crista**, which signifies comb or tuft.

Crests were used as marks of honour long before the introduction of Heraldry. The helmets and crests of the Greek and Trojan warriors are beautifully described by Homer. The German heralds pay great attention to crests, and depict them as towering to a great height above the helmet. Knights who were desirous of concealing their rank, or wished particularly to distinguish themselves either in the battle field or tourney, frequently decorated their helmets with plants or flowers, chimerical figures, animals, &c.; these badges were also assumed by their descendants. The difference between crests and badges as heraldic ornaments is, that the

former are always placed on a wreath, in the latter they are attached to the helmet. The scroll is a label or ribbon containing the motto: it is usually placed beneath the shield and supporters; see the word **MOTTO** in the Dictionary.



CHAP. VI.

MARSHALLING CHARGES ON ESCUTCHEONS BY THE RULES OF HERALDRY.

The symbolic figures of Heraldry are so well known to those acquainted with the science in every kingdom of Europe, that if an Englishman was to send a written emblazonment or description of an escutcheon to a French, German, or Spanish artist acquainted with the English language, either of them could return a properly drawn and coloured escutcheon; but a correct emblazonment would be indispensable. A single word omitted would spoil the shield.

I.

The reader has already been informed that in emblazoning an escutcheon, the colour of the field is first named; then the principal ordinary, such as the fess, the chevron, &c., naming the tincture and form of the ordinary; then proceed to describe the charges on the field, naming their situation, metal, or colour; lastly, describe the charges on the ordinary.

II.

When an honourable ordinary or some one figure is placed upon another, whether it be a fess, chevron, cross, &c., it is always to be named after the ordinary or figure over which it is placed, with either the words *surtout* or *overall*.

III.

In the blazoning such ordinaries as are plain, the bare mention of them is sufficient; but if an ordinary should be formed of any of the curved or angular lines, such as *invected*, *indented*, &c., the lines must be named.

IV.

When a principal figure possesses the centre of the field, its position is not to be expressed; it is always understood to be in the middle of the shield.

V.

When the situation of a principal bearing is not expressed, it is always understood to occupy the centre of the field. Ex. See **Azure, an annulet argent**, p. 48.

VI.

The number of the points of mullets must be specified if more than five: also if a mullet or any other charge is pierced, it must be mentioned.

VII.

When a ray of the sun or other single figure is borne in any other part of the escutcheon than the centre, the point it issues from must be named.

VIII.

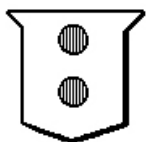
The natural colour of trees, plants, fruits, birds, &c., is to be expressed in emblazoning by the word **proper**; but if they vary from their natural colour, the tincture or metals that is used must be named.

IX.

Two metals cannot come in contact: thus or, cannot be placed on argent, but must be contrasted with a tincture.

X.

When there are many figures of the same species borne in coats of arms, their number must be observed as they stand, and properly expressed. The annexed arrangements of roundlets in shields will show how they are placed and described.

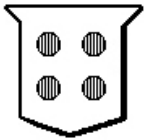


The two roundlets are arranged in pale, but they may appear in chief or base; or in fess, as in No. 2.



Three roundlets, two over one; if the single roundlet had been at the top, it would have been called **one over two**.

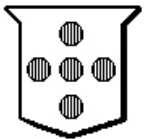
Three roundlets in bend. They might also be placed in fess, chief, base, or in pale.



Four roundlets, two over two. Some armorists call them ***cantoned*** as they form a square figure.



Five roundlets; two, one, two, in saltier.



Five roundlets; one, three, one, or in cross.



Six roundlets; two, two, two, paleway.



Six roundlets; three, two, one, in pile.

There are seldom more figures than seven, but no matter the number; they are placed in the same way, commencing with the figures at the top of the shield, or in chief. If the field was strewn all over with roundlets, this would be expressed by the word ***semé***.

Marshalling coats of arms, is the act of disposing the arms of several persons in one escutcheon, so that their relation to each other may be clearly marked.

In Heraldry, the husband and wife are called *baron and femme*; and when they are descended from distinct families, both their arms are placed in the same escutcheon, divided by a perpendicular line through the centre of the shield. As this line runs in the same direction, and occupies part of the space in the shield appropriated to the ordinary called the pale, the shield is in heraldic language said to be *parted per pale*. The arms of the baron (the husband) are always placed on the dexter side of the escutcheon; and the femme (the wife), on the sinister side, as in the annexed example.



Parted per pale, baron and femme, two coats; first, or, a chevron gules; second, barry of twelve pieces, azure and argent.

If a widower marries again, the arms of both his wives are placed on the sinister side, which is parted per fess; that is, parted by an horizontal line running in the direction of the fess, and occupying the same place. The arms of the first wife are placed in the upper compartment of the shield, called the chief; the arms of the second wife in the lower compartment, called the base.



Parted per pale, baron and femme, three coats;—first, gules, on a bend azure, three trefoils vert: second, parted per fess, in chief azure, a mascle or, with a label argent for difference. In base ermine, a fess, dancette gules. The same rule would apply if the husband had three or more wives; they would all be placed in the sinister division of the shield.

Where the baron marries an heiress, he does not impale his arms with hers, as in the preceding examples, but bears them in an escutcheon of pretence in the centre of the shield, showing his pretension to her lands in consequence of his marriage with the lady who is legally entitled to them. The escutcheon of pretence is not used by the children of such marriage; they bear the arms of their father and mother quarterly, and so transmit them to posterity. Annexed is an example of the arms of the femme on escutcheon of pretence.

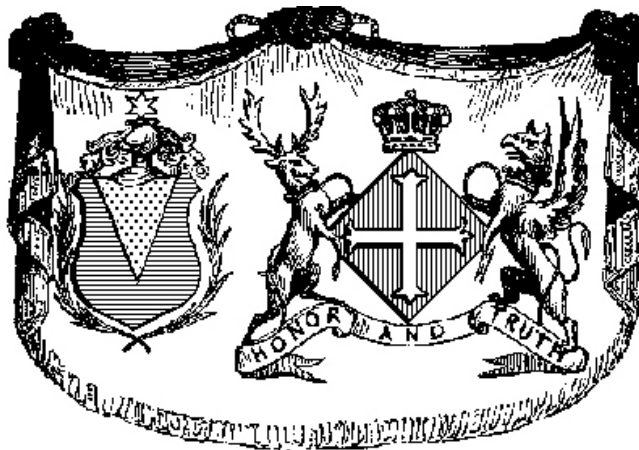


Baron and femme, two coats; first, gules, a saltier argent; second, on an escutcheon of pretence, azure, a chevron, or.

If a peeress in her own right, or the daughter of a peer, marries a private gentleman, their coats of arms are not conjoined paleways, as baron and femme, but are placed upon separate shields by the side of each other; they are usually inclosed in a mantel, the shield of the baron occupying the dexter side of the mantel, that of the femme the sinister; each party has a right to all the ornaments incidental to their rank. The femme claiming the arms of her father, has a right to his supporters and coronet. The baron, who only ranks as an esquire, has no right to supporters or coronet, but exhibits the proper helmet, wreath, and crest.

The peeress, by marrying one beneath her in rank, confers no dignity on her husband, but loses none of her own. She is still addressed as "your ladyship," though her husband only ranks as a gentleman; and it is for this reason that the arms cannot be conjoined in one shield as baron and femme.

Ex. Baron and femme, two atchievements. First, azure, a pile or, crest a star of six points, argent; second, gules, a cross flory argent, surmounted by an earl's coronet: supporters, on the dexter side a stag ducally gorged and chained, on the sinister side a griffin gorged and chained; motto, Honour and Truth.



In the arms of the femme joined to the paternal coat of the baron, the proper differences by which they were borne by the father of the lady must be inserted.

If the arms of the baron has a bordure, that must be omitted on the sinister side of the shield.

Archbishops and bishops impale the paternal arms with the arms of the see over which they preside, placing the arms of the bishopric on the dexter, and their paternal arms on the sinister side of the shield; a bishop does not emblazon the arms of his wife on the same shield with that which contains the arms of the see, but on a separate shield.

Arms of augmentation are marshalled according to the direction of the College of Heralds: they are usually placed on a canton in the dexter chief of the shield; in some cases they occupy the whole of the chief. The mark of distinction denoting a baronet is usually placed on an escutcheon, on the fess point of the shield.

The rules here laid down apply to funeral atchievements, banners, &c. The only difference, as will be seen by the annexed examples, is, that the ground of the hatchment is black, that surrounds the arms of the deceased, whether baron or femme, and white round the arms of the survivor.



In **fig. 1.** the black is left on the dexter side, showing that the husband is deceased, and that his wife survives him.



Fig. 2. shows that the husband survives the wife.



Fig. 3. shows that the husband and his first wife are deceased, and that the second wife is the survivor.



Fig. 4. The shield on the dexter side of the hatchment is parted per pale; first, the arms of the bishopric; second, the paternal arms of the bishop. The shield on the dexter side is the arms of the bishop impaling those of his wife as baron and femme; the ground of the hatchment is black round the sinister side of this shield, showing that it is the wife that is dead.



Fig. 5. is the hatchment of a lady that has died unmarried. The arms of females of all ranks are placed in a lozenge-shaped shield.

6



Fig. 6. is the hatchment of the widow of a bishop; the arms are the same as those displayed at fig. 4.: here the lozenge-shaped shield is parted per pale. Baron and femme:—first, parted paleways, on the dexter side the arms of the bishopric, on the sinister side the paternal arms of the bishop. Second, the arms of the femme: the widow of a bishop has a right to exhibit the arms of the see over which her husband presided, as though his death has dissolved all connection with the see. She has a right to emblazon all that will honour her deceased husband.

For banners, pennons, guidons, cyphers, hatchments, &c., and all other matters where heraldic emblazonment is used in funeral processions, the reader is referred to the Dictionary.

CHAP. VII.

ORDER OF PRECEDENCY.

The order of precedence to be observed in England was settled by an act of parliament passed in the thirty-first year of the reign of Henry VIII. The order has been varied at different periods to accord with the alterations in the families of the reigning monarchs, and the creation of new offices. The following table shows the order of precedence at the present time, viz. the eighth year of the reign of Queen Victoria.

The Queen.
The Prince of Wales.
The Queen's Children.
Prince Albert of Saxe Cobourg and Gotha.
The Queen's Uncles.
The Children of the Queen's Uncles.

The following dignitaries precede all Dukes, except those of the blood royal:—

Archbishop of Canterbury, primate of all England.
Lord High Chancellor or Keeper.
Archbishop of York, primate of England.
Lord High Treasurer.
Lord President of the Privy Council.
Lord Privy Seal.

The following dignitaries precede all of their own degree:—

The Earl Marshal.
Lord Steward of her Majesty's household.
Lord Chamberlain.
Secretaries of State.

Dukes according to the date of their patent.
Marquises according to the date of their patent.
Dukes' eldest Sons.
Earls according to their patents.
Marquises' eldest Sons.
Dukes' younger Sons.
Viscounts according to their patents.
Earls' eldest Sons.
Marquises' younger Sons.
Bishops of London, Durham, and Winchester; all other Bishops according to their seniority of consecration.

Barons according to their patents.
Speaker of the House of Commons.
Viscounts' eldest Sons.
Earls' younger Sons.
Barons' eldest Sons.
Knights of the Garter, commoners.
Privy Councillors, commoners.
Chancellor of the Exchequer.
Chancellor of the Duchy of Lancaster.
Lord Chief Justice of the King's Bench.
Master of the Rolls.
The Vice-Chancellor of England.
Lord Chief Justice of the Common Pleas.
Lord Chief Baron of the Exchequer.
Judges and Barons of the degree of the Coif, according to seniority
Viscounts' younger Sons.
Barons' younger Sons.
Baronets.
Knights of the Bath.
Knights Commanders of the Bath.
Field and Flag Officers.
Knights Bachelors.
Masters in Chancery.
Doctors graduate.
Serjeants at Law.
Esquires of the King's Body.
Esquires of the Knights of the Bath.
Esquires by creation.
Esquires by office.
Clergymen, Barristers at Law, Officers in the Royal Navy and Army who are Gentlemen
by Profession, and Gentlemen entitled to bear arms.
Citizens.
Burgesses.

The Lords Spiritual of Ireland rank next after the Lords Spiritual of Great Britain; the priority of signing any treaty or public instrument by the members of the government is always taken by rank of place, not by title.

The style prefixed to the titles of the peerage of Great Britain and Ireland are as follows :—

Princes of the Blood, His Royal Highness.
Archbishops, His Grace.
Dukes, The Most Noble His Grace.
Marquesses, the Most Honorable.
Earls, Viscounts, and Barons, The Right Honorable.
Bishops, The Right Reverend.

DICTIONARY

OF

HERALDIC TERMS

BAISSÉ. A French word, generally used in heraldry instead of the English word abased. When the fess, or any other ordinary properly placed above the fess point of the shield, is brought below it, that ordinary is said to be *abaissé*.

BATEMENT. Any figure added to coats of arms tending to lower the dignity or station of the bearer. Thus, the baton, denoting illegitimacy, is an abatement: so, also, are the differences in coats of arms showing the degrees of consanguinity.

DDORSED. Any animals set back to back. See **LION**.

LLERION. An eagle displayed, without beak or feet.

Ex. **Argent, an allerion gules.**



LTERNATE. Figures or tinctures that succeed each other by turns.

METHYST. A precious stone of a violet colour, the name of which was formerly used instead of purpure, to denote the purple tincture when emblazoning the arms of the English nobility.

NNULET. A small circle borne as a charge in coats of arms.

Ex. **Azure, an annulet argent.** Annulets are added to arms for a difference. See **DIFFERENCES**, p. 13.



NCIENT. A small flag or ensign. The bearer of the flag was called by its name. *Iago* was ancient to the troops commanded by *Othello*.

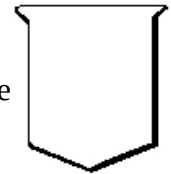
"This is Othello's ancient, as I take it.
The same indeed, a very valiant fellow."

SHAKSPEARE.

ARCHBISHOPS. Church dignitaries of the first class. There are but two in England—the Archbishop of Canterbury and the Archbishop of York. The former is the first peer of England next to the royal family, and has the title of *Grace* given to him; and likewise *Most Reverend Father in God*. He is styled Primate of all England, and Metropolitan.

The Archbishop of York has precedence of dukes and great officers of state, except the lord chancellor. He is called *His Grace* and *Most Reverend Father in God*; and styled *Primate of England* and *Metropolitan*.

ARGENT. The French word for silver, of which metal all white fields or charges are supposed to consist.



ARMED. This word is used to express the horns, hoofs, beak, or talons of any beast or bird of prey, when borne of a different tincture from those of their bodies.



Ex. Crest, a demi-griffin armed, gules.

ARMORIST. A person skilled in the bearings of coats of arms, and all relating to their emblazonment.

ARMS. A word derived from the Latin *arma*, which signifies in Heraldry a mark of honour, serving to distinguish states, cities, families, &c.

ARROWS. Short darts feathered at the ends.



Ex. Argent, three arrows paleways, points in chief sable, feathered.

ASPECTANT. Animals placed face to face in a charge are said to be aspectant. If they are about to attack each other, they are said to be combatant.

SSUMPTIVE. Arms assumed without being sanctioned by a grant from the College of Heralds.

SSURGENT. A man or beast rising out of the sea is said to be assurgent.

TCHIEVEMENT. The coat of arms fully emblazoned according to the rules of Heraldry. The lozenge-shaped atchievements that are displayed on the outside of the houses of persons deceased are commonly called Hatchments.

TTIRED. When the horns of a stag are of a different tincture to its head, it is said to be attired.

Ex. **Argent, a stag lodged, proper, attired, or**



UGMENTATION. This word signifies in Heraldry a particular mark of honour, granted by the sovereign in consideration of some noble action, or by favour; and either quartered with the family arms, or on an escutcheon or canton.

Ex. **Ermine, on a chevron azure, three foxes' heads erased, argent. The augmentation is in a canton azure, a fleur-de-lis argent.**



ZURE. The French word for *blue*: it is distinguished in heraldic engraving by lines running parallel to each other in an horizontal direction, as in the annexed example.



ADGE. A distinctive mark worn by servants, retainers, and followers of royalty or nobility, who, being beneath the rank of gentlemen, have no right to armorial bearings. The rose and crown is the badge of the servants, &c., of the Kings of England: they are displayed as in the annexed example.

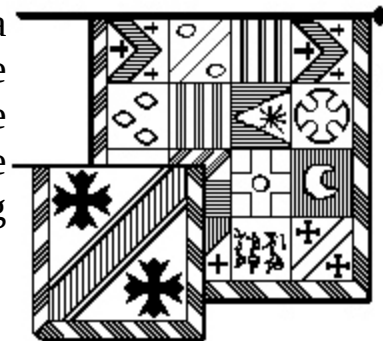
ANDED. Anything tied with a band.

Ex. **Argent.** Three arrows proper, banded.



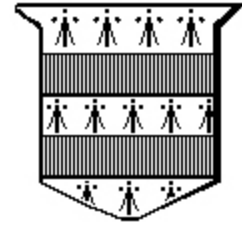
ANNER. The principal standard of a knight. The great banner borne at the funeral of a nobleman contains all the quarterings of his arms: it varies in size according to the rank of the deceased. The banner of the sovereign is five feet square; that of a prince or duke, four feet square; for all noblemen of inferior rank, three feet square.

ANNER ROLL is a small square flag containing a single escutcheon of the deceased. Thus, if there are twelve quarterings in the banner, the same number of banner rolls will be required to be borne in the funeral procession. The annexed engraving shows the banner and banner-roll.



AR. An honourable ordinary, occupying one-fifth of the shield. It may be placed in any part of the field. It has two diminutives, the closet and barrulet.

Ex. **Ermine, two bars gules.**



ARBED. Bearded. It is also applied to roses.

Ex. **Azure, a rose argent, barbed, and seeded proper.**



ARON. The lowest title of the peerage of Great Britain.

ARON AND FEMME. Terms used in Heraldry to denote the arms of a man and his wife, marshalled together. See **p. 38**.

ARRULET. The smallest diminutive of the bar. The closet is half the bar; the barrulet half the closet.

Ex. **Gules, two barrulets argent.**



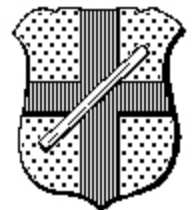
ARRY. A field divided transversely into several equal parts, and consisting of two different tinctures interchangeably disposed.

Ex. **Barry of eight pieces, azure and argent.**



ATON. BATUNE. BASTON. It is generally used as an abatement in coats of arms to denote illegitimacy.

Ex. **Or, a cross gules, over all a baton argent.**



ATTERING RAM. An instrument used for battering down walls before gunpowder was known in Europe: it is frequently borne as a charge in a coat of arms.

Ex. **Argent, a battering ram proper.**

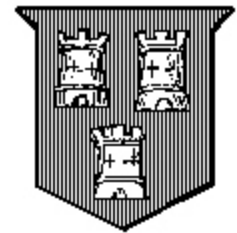


ATTLE AXE. An ancient military weapon, frequently borne on arms as a mark of prowess.



Ex. **Argent, three battle axes gules two over one.**

ATTLEMENTS. Divisions or apertures on the top of castle walls or towers.



Ex. **Gules, three towers embattled argent.**

EAKED. The beak of a bird being of a different tint from the body is said to be beaked.



Ex. **An eagle's head erased, beaked, or.**

EAVER. That part of the helmet that defends the sight.

ELLED. Having bells.



Ex. **Argent, a barrulet gules, belled with three bells proper.**



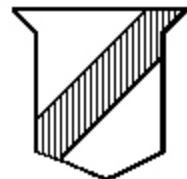
END. One of the honourable ordinaries formed by two diagonal lines drawn from the dexter chief to the sinister base; it generally occupies a fifth part of the shield if uncharged, but if charged one third.

Ex. **Azure, a bend argent.**



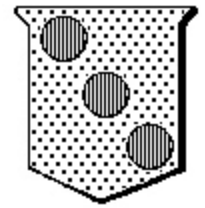
END SINISTER. Is the reverse of the bend; it is seldom found in coats of arms, as it is reckoned an abatement.

Ex. **Argent, a bend sinister gules.**



¶ **BEND.** Figures placed in a slanting direction from the dexter chief to the sinister base are said to be in bend.

Ex. Or, three torteaux in bend.



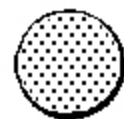
ENDLET. A diminutive of the bend, of the same shape, but only half the width of the bend.

ENDY. This word serves to denote a field divided diagonally into several bends, varying in metal and colour.

Ex. **Bendy of six pieces, azure and argent.**

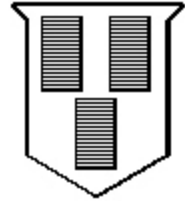


ESANT, or BEZANT. Gold coin of Byzantium; when they appear in a coat of arms their colour is not described: a besant is always or.



ILLETS. This charge is, by some authors, supposed to represent tiles or bricks; by others that it represents a letter or billet. The name and form of the charge most accords with the latter opinion.

Ex. **Argent, three billets azure, two over one.**



ISHOPS. Church dignitaries: they are barons of the realm, and have precedence next to viscounts: they have the title of *lords*, and *right reverend fathers in God*.

LAZON. To describe in proper colours, or lines representing colours, all that belongs to coats of arms. Arms may also be emblazoned by describing the charges and tinctures of a coat of arms in heraldic terms.

LUE-MANTEL. A title of one of the pursuivants at arms. See HERALD.

ORDURE or BORDER. This was the most ancient difference in coats of arms, to distinguish different branches of the same family. It is a border round the edge of the shield. Its situation is always the same; but the inner edge may be varied.

Ex. **Argent, a sinister hand couped at the wrist and erected gules, within a bordure azure.**



OTTONNY. See CROSS BOTTONNY.

OUJET. An ancient water bucket, frequently borne in shields of arms.

Ex. **Argent, a boujet proper.**



RACED. Two figures of the same form, interlacing each other.

Ex. **Vert, two triangles braced, argent.**



RASED and **BRAZED** are words sometimes used by ancient armorists. They always describe things interlaced or braced together.

ROAD ARROW. An ancient weapon of war, thrown by an engine. It is frequently borne as a charge in coats of arms.

Ex. **Argent, a broad arrow gules.**



ABOCHED or CABOSHED. Beasts' heads borne without any part of the neck, and full faced.

Ex. **Argent, a stag's head caboshed, proper.**

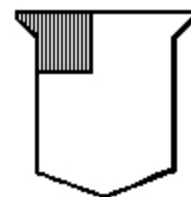


ALTROP. An iron instrument made to annoy an enemy's cavalry. They were formed of iron, being four spikes conjoined in such a manner that one was always upwards. It is found in many ancient coats of arms.

Ex. **Argent, a caltrop proper.**



ANTON. The French word for corner. It is a small square figure, generally placed at the dexter chief of the shield, as in the annexed example.



ELESTIAL CROWN. Distinguished from any other crown by the stars on the points or rays that proceed from the circlet.



HAPEAU. Cap of maintenance or dignity, borne only by sovereign princes. It is formed of crimson or scarlet velvet, lined with ermine.



HAPLET. An ancient ornament for the head, granted to gallant knights for acts of courtesy. It is frequently borne as a charge in a shield of arms, and always tinted in its natural colours.

Ex. **Argent, a chaplet proper.**



HARGE. The figures or bearings contained in an escutcheon.

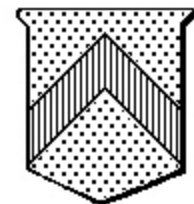
HECKY. The field covered with alternate squares of metal and fur.

Ex. **Checky, sable and argent.**



HEVRON. This ordinary is supposed to represent the rafters of the gable of a house.

Ex. **Or, a chevron gules.**



HEVRONEL. The diminutive of the chevron, being one half its size.



Ex. **Argent, two chevronels gules.**

CHIEF. One of the honourable ordinaries. It is placed on the upper part of the shield and contains a third part of it. The letters show the points in the chief. A is the dexter chief; B, the precise middle chief; C, the sinister chief.



HIMERICAL FIGURES. Imaginary figures, such as griffins, dragons, harpies, &c.: all of them will be found under their proper names.



INQUE FOIL. Five leaves conjoined in the centre.

IVIC CAP. A cap of dignity borne by mayors of cities or corporate bodies: it is formed of sables garnished with ermine.



LARION. A horn or trumpet borne in this shape in English and German coat-armour.

Ex. **Azure, three clarions or.**



LENCHED. The fingers pressed towards the palm of the hand.

Ex. **Azure, a dexter arm vambraced coupé, the fist clenched proper.**

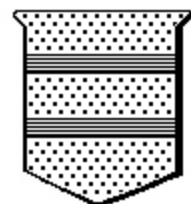


LOSE. A bird with its wings closed.



LOSET. A diminutive of the bar, being only one half its width.

Ex. **Or, two closets azure.**

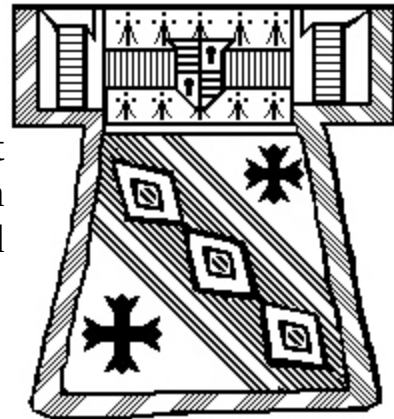


LOSEGIRT. A figure whose dress is fastened round the waist.

Ex. **Gules**, an angel erect with wings expanded or, dress closegirt.



OAT ARMOUR, or Surcoat. A loose garment worn over the armour of a knight; hence the term coat of arms. On this garment were emblazoned the armorial bearings of the wearer.



OCKATRICE. A chimerical animal, a cock with a dragon's tail and wings.



OLLARED. Having a collar. Dogs and inferior animals are sometimes collared: the supporters and charges are generally said to be gorged. See

GORGED.

OMBATANT. A French word for fighting. See **LION.**

OMPLEMENT. The Heraldic term for the full moon. When this figure is introduced as a charge in a coat of arms, it is called a moon in her complement.

OMPONY. A term applied to a bordure, pale, bend, or any other ordinary, made up of squares of alternate metal and colour.

Ex. **Argent, an inescutcheon azure, border compony, or and gules.**



ONJOINED. Joined together.

Ex. **Argent, three legs armed, conjoined at the fess point at the upper extremity of the thigh, flexed in a triangle, garnished and spurred, or.**



ONY. An heraldic name for a young rabbit.

OTICE. One of the diminutives of the bend: cotices are generally borne on each side of the bend.

Ex. **Gules, a bend argent, coticed of the same.**



The cotices are frequently of a different tincture from the bend they cotice.

OUCHANT. The French word for lying down with the breast towards the earth, and the head raised. See **LION COUCHANT**.

OUNT. A nobleman that was deputed by the king to govern a county or shire: the title is not used in the British Peerage; his rank is equal to an earl.

OUNTER. In Heraldry implies contrariety, as in the following examples:—

OUNTER-CHANGED. The intermixture of metal with colours opposed to each other.

Ex. **Per pale, or and azure, on a chevron, three mullets all counter-changed.**



OUNTER SALIENT. Two animals leaping different ways from each other.



Ex. **Argent, two foxes counter salient.**

OUNTER PASSANT. Two animals passing the contrary way to each other.

Ex. Or, two lions passant counter passant gules, the uppermost facing the sinister side of the escutcheon, both collared sable, garnished argent.



COUNTER FLORY. Any ordinary ornamented with fleurs-de-luce: the points of the flowers run alternately in a contrary direction.



Ex. Or, a pale purple, flory and counter flory gules.

COUPED. From the French word *couper*, to cut. The cross in the example is coupé, part of it being cut off, so as not to touch the edges of the shield.



Ex. Azure, a cross coupé argent.

COUPED. The head or limbs of any animal cut close is called coupé.



Ex. Argent, a boar's head proper coupé.

OUPLE-CLOSE. One of the diminutives of the chevron, half the size of the chevronel.

Ex. Argent, three couple-closes interlaced vert.



OURANT. Running.

Ex. Argent, a stag proper courant.



RENELLE. The French heraldic term for embattled. See **EMBATTLED.**



RESCENT. The half moon with its horns turned upwards.

Ex. Azure, a crescent argent.



REST. The ornament on the upper part of the helmet in Heraldry placed over coats of arms, either with or without the helmet. By referring to the title-page of this work the crests of Great Britain will be found with all the adornments of regal helmets.

The English crest is a crown surmounted by a lion statant guardant crowned, or.

The Scottish crest is an imperial crown, surmounted by a lion sejant guardant, displaying two sceptres or.

The Irish crest is an ancient diadem surmounted by an embattled tower, a stag courant issuing from the portal.

The crest of Wales is a dragon passant guardant, gules.—The whole of these crests, with mantlings, &c., are emblazoned on the title-page of this Manual.

Crests are usually displayed upon a wreath as in the annexed example, which is a demi-lion rampant. If a crest this size had been placed upon an helmet of proportionate size it must have occupied a sixth part of this page, and the shield containing the arms to be in proportion considerably larger: in showing the crest without the helmet proportion is of little consequence. See HELMET, WREATH, and MANTLING.



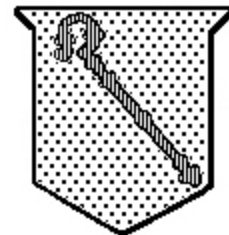
RESTED. A cock or other bird, whose comb is of a different tincture from the body, is said to be crested. See JOWLOPED.

RINED. This is said of an animal whose hair is of a different tincture from its body.



Ex. **Argent, a mermaid gules, crined or.**

ROSIER. The pastoral staff of a bishop or abbot: a very frequent charge in ecclesiastical arms.

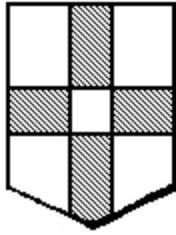


Ex. **Or, a crosier gules, in bend.**

ROSS. An honourable ordinary, more used as a charge in a coat of arms than any of the others. During the Crusades for the recovery of the Holy Land, the troops of the different nations that joined in the Crusade displayed crosses on their banners and arms: every soldier bore a cross upon his dress; this was composed of two pieces of list or riband of equal length, crossing each other at right angles. The soldiers of France attached their national emblem, the fleur-de-lis, to the ends of the members of the cross; hence the introduction of the cross flory. The Crusaders from the Papal dominions

placed transverse pieces on each member of the plain cross, and by this means transformed it into four small crosses springing from a centre, forming what is now called the cross-crosslet. It would be impossible within the limits of this work to give an example of all the crosses that have been introduced as bearings in coats of arms. Berry, in his comprehensive work on Heraldry, gives nearly two hundred examples, without giving all that might be found. The following are the crosses most used in English Heraldry.

Cross		Cross potent	
Cross flory		Cross crosslet	
Cross bottonny		Cross pattee	
Cross raguly		Cross patonce	
Cross moline		Cross quadrate	
Cross quarter-pierced		Cross of Calvary	



Cross fitchy



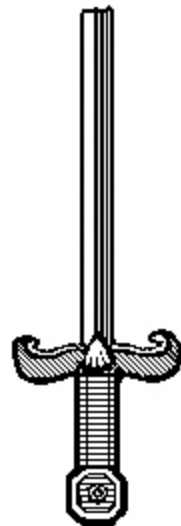
Cross patriarchal



Cross potent rebated



URTANA. The pointless sword of mercy is the principal in dignity of the three swords that are borne naked before the British monarchs at their coronation.



CROWN AND CORONETS.

**The crown of the king
of England.**

**Coronet of the prince
of Wales**



Of a princess of England



Of a marquis



Of a royal duke



Of an earl



Of a duke



Of a viscount

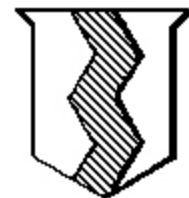


Coronet of a baron



ANCETTE. A zig-zag figure with spaces between the points, much larger than in the indented.

Ex. Argent, a pale, dancette vert.



EBRUISED. Any animal that has an ordinary placed upon it is said to be debruised.

Ex. **Argent, a lion rampant guardant gules, debruised by a fess azure.**



ECRESSANT, or DECRESCENT. A moon in its wane, whose horns are turned to the sinister side of the escutcheon.

Ex. **Azure, a moon decrescent, proper.**



EMI, or DEMY. This particle is always joined to a substantive, and signifies half; as, a demi-lion, *i.e.* half a lion.

ETRIMENT. The moon is said to be in its detriment when it is eclipsed.

Ex. **Argent, the moon in her detriment sable.**



EXTER. A word used in Heraldry to signify the right side of any thing.

IADEM, a circle of gold with points rising from it, worn by ancient kings as the token of royalty. The diadem of most of the monarchs of Europe, as represented in ancient statuary, stained glass, and paintings, resembles the annexed engraving; the kings of England, from the Conquest to Henry VII., all wore a diadem of this shape.



IAMOND. The hardest and most valuable of precious stones; it was formerly used by English heralds to denote black or sable in blazoning the arms of the nobility.

IFFERENCE. The term given to a certain figure added to coats of arms to distinguish one family from another, and to show how distant younger branches are from the elder or principal branch. See p. 13.

IMINUTION. A word sometimes used instead of difference.

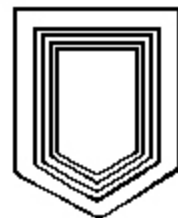
ISPLAYED. A bird whose wings are expanded and legs spread is said to be displayed.



Ex. **Argent**, an eagle displayed **sable**.

ORMANT. The French word for sleeping, used to denote the posture of a lion, or any other beast reposing. See LION.

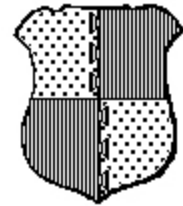
OUBLINGS. The lining of robes of state, as also the rows of fur set on the mantles of peers.



OUBLE TRESSURE. Two Tressures, or orles, one within the other.

OVETAILED. A term borrowed from carpentry to show tinctures joined together by reversed wedges, which, being shaped like doves' tails, are by joiners called dovetailing.

Ex. **Quarterly per pale dove-tailed, or and gules.**



RAGON.. An imaginary monster; a mixture of beast, bird, and reptile. It is frequently borne in crests and charges.

Ex. **Argent, a dragon proper, tail nowed.**



RAGON'S HEAD. Part of a celestial constellation, used by ancient English heralds to denote tenne when emblazoning the arms of sovereigns; this style of heraldry has become obsolete.

RAGON'S TAIL. Part of the same constellation; formerly used to denote sanguine.

UKE. The highest degree of British peerage next to the prince of Wales. This title is derived from the Latin word ***dux***: the title of Duke was known in other parts of Europe long before it was introduced into England. The first person that was created a duke in this country was Edward the Black Prince, who was created duke of Cornwall by his father Edward the third. The title has since that time belonged to the first born son of the monarch of

England. A duke formerly possessed great authority over the province that formed his dukedom, and had large estates annexed to his title to support its dignity. At the present time dukes are created by patent, and their dukedom is merely nominal, neither power nor possessions being annexed to the title.

AGLE. *Aquila* in Ornithology. In Heraldry the eagle is accounted one of the most noble bearings, and ought to be given only to such as greatly excel in the virtues of generosity and courage, or for having done some singular service to their sovereign.

AGLET is a diminutive of eagle, properly signifying a young eagle. In Heraldry, when several eagles are on the same escutcheon, they are termed eaglets.

ARL. The third degree of British peerage. Under the Danish and Saxon kings this was the highest title known in England conferred upon a subject. It was formerly the custom upon creating an earl to assign him, for the support of his state, the third penny from the fines and profits of the sheriff's court, issuing out of the pleas of the shire whence the earl took his title; as, formerly, there was no count or earl but had a county or shire for his earldom. When the number of earls was increased, they took their titles from towns and villages. An earl is now created by patent.

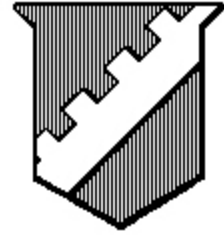
ARL-MARSHAL OF ENGLAND. A very ancient, and formerly a very important, officer, who had several courts under his jurisdiction, as the Court of Chivalry, the Court of Honour. He still presides over the Herald's College, and nominally over the Marshalsea Court. The title of Earl Marshal of England is now, and has been for some ages, hereditary in the noble family of the Howards.

ASTERN CROWN. A crown with rays proceeding from a circle, called by heralds an Eastern crown, is found in ancient achievements. The annexed cut shows its form.



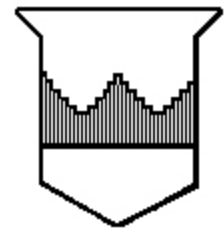
MBATTLED. A line, formed like the battlements on a wall or tower, is said to be embattled or crenelle. When the line is used to form one of the ordinaries, it is said to be embattled. See the lines, **p. 11.**

Ex. **Gules, a bend sinister embattled, argent.**



EMBATTLED GRADY. Where the battlements gradually rise one above another.

Ex. **Argent, a fess gules, embattled grady.** See the lines p. 11.



EMBOWED. Any thing bent or curved, like a bow.

Ex. **Gules, a dolphin naiant embowed or.**



EMERALD. The name of a precious stone formerly substituted for vert in emblazoning the arms of the nobility of England.

EN ARRIÈRE. An expression borrowed from the French, to signify any creature borne with its back to view.

Ex. **Argent, an eagle proper en arrière.**



NDORSE. The smallest diminutive of the pale.



Ex. **Argent, a pale between endorses gules.**

NGRAILED. Any object being edged with small semi-circles, the points turning outwards, is said to be engrailed.



Ex. **Argent, a pale azure engrailed.**

NHANCED. A term applied to bearings placed above their usual situation.



Ex. **Argent, three bendlets, enhanced gules.**

NSIGNED. This word, in heraldic description, means ornamented.

Ex. Argent, a man's heart gules, ensigned with a celestial crown or.



RASED. Signifies any thing torn or plucked off from the part to which nature affixed it; generally applied to the head and limbs of man or beast.

Ex. Argent, a leg erased at the midst of the thigh gules.

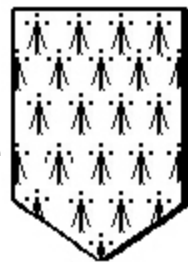


RECT. This is said of any animal or parts of animals, naturally horizontal, being placed in a perpendicular direction.

Ex. Argent, a boar's head erect, and erased.



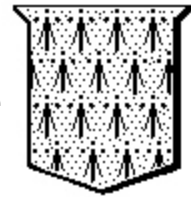
RMINE. A white fur with black spots, represented as in the annexed example.



RMINES. This fur is represented by white spots on a black field.



RMINOIS. A fur, the field, or, the spots or tufts, sable, as in the annexed example.



SCALOP. The shell of a sea-fish, used to decorate the palmers on their way to and from Palestine; frequently used as a charge in Heraldry.



SCUTCHEON. This word is sometimes used to express the whole coat of arms, sometimes only the field upon which the arms are painted. It more generally denotes the painted shields used at funerals. The field, if the husband is dead and wife survives, is black on the dexter side only; if the wife is deceased, it is black on the sinister side; if both, it is black all over. The example shows that this is the escutcheon of a deceased baron, whose lady survives.



SCUTCHEON OF PRETENCE. A small escutcheon, on which a man bears the coat of arms of his wife, being an heiress.

See p. 40.

Ex. Argent, a chevron or, between three crosslets sable, on the fess point surtout the chevron an escutcheon of pretence gules, three quatrefoils argent.



SQUIRE. The degree below a knight and above a gentleman. Those to whom this title is due by right, are all the younger sons of noblemen and their heirs male for ever, the four esquires of the king's body, the eldest sons of baronets, of all knights and of their heirs male: those who bear superior offices, as magistrates, high sheriffs, mayors, and aldermen, have it during their continuance in office and no longer. For the helmet of an esquire, see [page 84](#).



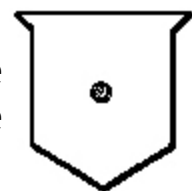
TOILE. The French word for a star. It differs from the mullet in the number of points, and four of the points being rayant.

ESS. An honourable ordinary occupying the third part of the shield between the centre and the base.

Ex. Argent, a fess gules.



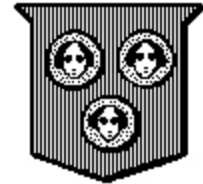
ESS POINT. The exact centre of the escutcheon, as seen in the annexed example. See the escutcheon lettered at [p. 6.](#), where this point is marked with the letter E.



IELD. The whole surface of the shield or escutcheon: it is the ground upon which the colours, tinctures, furs, ordinaries, and charges, are represented.

IGURED. Those bearings which are depicted with a human face, are said to be figured.

Ex. **Gules, three bezants figured.**



ILLET. The only diminutive belonging to the chief; its width is one-fourth of the chief, and is always placed at the base of it. See **CHIEF**, p. 18.

IMBRIATED. An ordinary having a border of a different tincture is said to be fimbriated.

Ex. **Azure, a bend gules, fimbriated argent.**



ITCHY. Is from the French word *fiché*, fixed. It is generally applied to crosses which have their lower branch pointed, so that it could be fixed in the ground. See **CROSS FITCHY**.

LANCHES. Are formed of two curved lines placed opposite each other.

Ex. Azure, a flanche argent.



LANK. That part of an escutcheon between the chief and the base.

Ex. Argent, three mullets gules, accompanied with seven cross crosslets fitchy sable—three in chief, one in fess, two in flanks, one in base.



LASQUES. A subordinate ordinary formed by curved lines placed opposite each other, but not so near as in flanches.



Ex. Azure, a flasque argent.



LEUR-DE-LIS. Supposed to represent the garden-lily. It is the bearing of the Bourbons of France, but is frequently introduced in English charges.

LORY. Signifies flowered or adorned with the fleur-de-lis. See FLORY COUNTER-FLORY, and CROSS-FLORY.

RET. Two laths interlaced with a mascle.

Ex. **Azure**, a fret argent.



FRETTY. This word denotes a field covered with fretwork or laths interlacing each other.



Ex. **Gules**, fretty argent.

THE FUSIL. Is longer than the lozenge: the upper and lower ends are more acute.



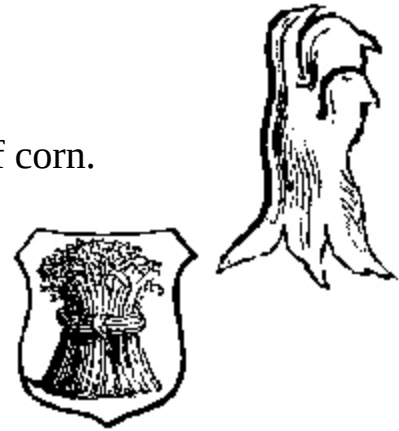
Ex. **Or**, a fusil purpure.



GALLEY. An ancient vessel propelled by oars; frequently used in shields of naval officers.

AMBE. An obsolete French word, signifying a leg, and is still used in Heraldry, for the leg of a lion or other creature borne in coats of arms.

GARBE. The heraldic term for a sheaf of any kind of corn.



Ex. **Argent, a garbe proper.**

ARTER. One of the diminutives of the bend, being half the size.



Ex. **Or, a garter vert.**

ARTER. The insignia of the most noble order of the knights of the garter. It is formed of blue velvet edged with gold wire, and lined with white satin; on the velvet is embroidered the motto of the order. See **KNIGHT**.



AUNTLET. Armour for the hand.



AZE. An intent look. This is said of a deer standing still, and turning its head to look earnestly at any object.

Ex. **Argent, a stag at gaze proper.**



EMELS. This word signifies double. The example contains two double bars, which in heraldic language would be called two bars gemels.



OLPS. Roundlets of a purple tincture. The colour is not stated, as the name denotes the colour.



ORGED. Any animals, particularly birds, that have collars round the neck, are said to be gorged.

Ex. **A swan's head erased at the neck, ducally gorged or.**



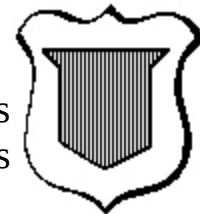
RIFFIN or **GRYPHON**. A chimerical animal, half bird, half beast.



UIDON. A small semi-oval flag used in funeral processions. It is generally charged with the paternal arms of the deceased.



ULES. Signifies red. It is represented in engraving by lines running parallel with each other, from the chief to the base, as in the example.



UTTY. A term derived from the Latin word *gutta*, a drop. A field bearing drops, as in the example, is called gutty.

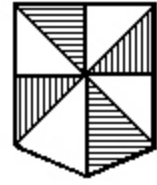


YRON. A triangular figure formed by two lines from one of the angles of the shield to the centre. The gyron may be drawn in any part of the shield, but it is generally placed as in the annexed example.



YRONNY. When the field is covered with gyrons, their points uniting in the centre.

Ex. Gyronny of eight pieces, azure, argent, and gules.



ABERGEON. A coat of mail: it is also called a corslet and cuirass.



Ex. **Argent, an habergeon proper.**

ABITED. Clothed figures, either as charges or supporters, are said to be habited.



ARPY. A chimerical animal, having the head and breast of a woman, and the body and legs of a bird.

AURIENT. A fish, in a perpendicular direction, with its head upwards.



Ex. **Argent, a salmon proper haurient.**

HELMET. An ancient piece of defensive armour for the head; it covered the face, leaving an aperture in the front, secured by bars: this was called the visor. The helmet is now placed over a coat of arms; and by the metal from which it is made, the form, and position, denotes the rank of the person whose arms are emblazoned beneath it.

The helmets of sovereigns are formed of burnished gold; those of princes and peers, of every degree, silver figured with gold; knights, esquires, and gentlemen, polished steel.

The helmets of the king, the royal family, and peers, are open-faced and grated: the number of bars served formerly to distinguish the bearer's quality. The helmets of knights are open-faced, without bars. Esquires and gentlemen are known by the close helmet.

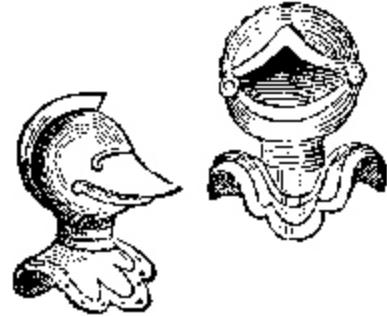
The position of the helmet is a mark of distinction. The direct front view of the grated helmet belongs to sovereign princes and dukes.



The grated helmet in profile is common to all degrees of peerage under a duke.



The helmet without bars, with the beaver open, standing directly fronting the spectator, denotes a knight.



The closed helmet seen in profile is appropriated to esquires and gentlemen.

See CREST, BEAVER, MANTLING.

HERALD. An officer at arms, whose business it is to declare war, proclaim peace, marshal all the solemnities at the coronation; baptisms, marriages, and funerals of the sovereign and nobility; and to ascertain and blazon coats of arms.

The principal herald is **Garter-King-at-Arms**. It is his office to regulate the solemnities, and emblazon the arms of the sovereign, knights, and officers of the most noble order of the Garter. **Garter-King-at-Arms** likewise presides over all heraldic ceremonies of the Court. His crown of gold is formed with oak leaves, one shorter than the other, springing from a circlet of gold, having engraved upon it the words "MISERERE MEI DEUS." His tabard, as principal herald, is of crimson velvet, splendidly embroidered with the arms of England.

Clarencieux and Norroy are called **provincial kings-at-arms**, the former regulating all things connected with Heraldry in the provinces south of the Trent; the latter in the provinces north of the Trent. They have likewise crowns; and though the office of herald is not of so much importance now as it was formerly, it is still considered a post of great honour and emolument.

There are eight heralds that are not kings-at-arms. Their tabards are of silk, embroidered with the royal arms. They are called York, Lancaster, Somerset, Richmond, Chester, and Windsor. George the First created a new herald called Hanover, and another called Gloucester.

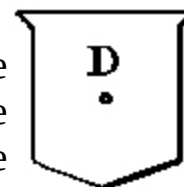
The kings-at-arms, heralds, and pursuivants, form the Herald's College, by whom all matters connected with the coats of arms of every gentleman in the kingdom are arranged and determined.

ILTED. The handle of a sword tinctured.

Ex. **Argent, a sword proper couped, hilted or.**



HONOUR POINT. That part of the shield between the precise middle chief and the fess point. In the annexed example the large dot in the centre shows the fess point; the point within the letter D, the *honour point*.



See p. 6.

HORNED. This term is used to denote that the horn of a unicorn is of a different tincture from his body.

Ex. **Azure, three unicorns' heads proper, erased, horned or.**



HUMETTY. A term used to denote an ordinary, parts of which are couped or cut off, so that it does not touch the edges of the shield.

Ex. **Argent, a fess humetty gules, between three mullets sable.**

URTS. Blue roundlets: the colour is expressed in the name; therefore the tincture is not otherwise named in emblazoning a coat of arms.

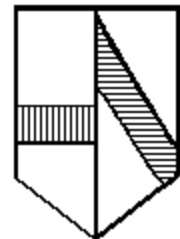


MBUED. Weapons spotted with blood are said to be imbued. The example shows a spearhead imbued.



MPALED. Two coats of arms, conjoined paleways, in one shield.

Ex. **Argent, a fess gules, impaled with argent, a bend azure.** See p. 38.



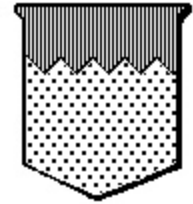
NCRESCENT. The new moon, with her horns turned towards the dexter side of the shield.

Ex. **Azure, a moon increscent argent.**



INDENTED. A serrated figure, much smaller than the dancette.

Ex. Or, a chief gules, indented.



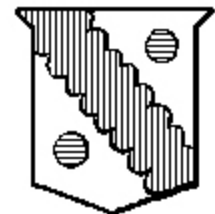
INESCUTCHEON. The name given to small escutcheons forming a bearing of a coat of arms.

Ex. Argent, three inescutcheons gules.



INVECTED. A line formed with small semicircles, with the points turned inward. Any ordinary drawn with this line is called invected.

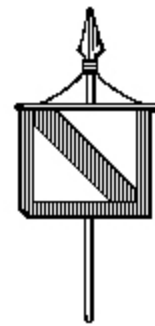
Ex. Argent, a bend gules, invected between two hurts.



ISSUANT, or ISSUING. Rays or other charges proceeding from any part of the escutcheon. See RAY.

NIGHT. A title of honour conferred upon a subject for eminent services performed in war. In the course of time, knights that had gained riches and high titles formed societies under the control and direction of their monarchs in every part of Europe. The limits of this work will only permit us to notice the orders of knighthood introduced into England.

The **KNIGHTS-BACHELORS** were the earliest order of knighthood in England. The title was conferred for services in war. It was merely personal, and, like the knighthood conferred upon individuals at the present time, did not descend to their posterity.



NIGHTS-BANNERET. This ancient and honourable order has become extinct. It obtained the title of banneret from the knights having the right of having a square banner borne before them on the field of battle, and at jousts and tournaments. Sir W. Segar gives the following account of the creation of a knight-banneret:—"It is a military order, and can only be conferred upon persons that have performed some heroic act in the field. When this action is known to the king, or general of the army, he commands the attendance of the gallant warrior, who is led, between two knights, into the presence of the king or general with his pennon of arms in his hand, and there the heralds proclaim his merit, and declare him fit to become a knight-banneret, and thenceforth to display a banner in the field. Then the king or general causes the point of the pennon to be cut off to make it square; it is then placed at the top of his lance, and the new-made knight returns to his tent, the trumpets sounding before him." Knights-banneret were certainly created in the reign of Edward I., but how long before that time it is impossible to tell.

NIGHTS OF THE GARTER. This is considered the most honourable order of knighthood in Europe: it was founded by Edward III. in 1349; the fraternity consists of twenty-six knights, to which are added the princes of the blood royal. The king of England is the sovereign of the order; their officers are a prelate, chancellor, registrar, and king-at-arms.

The college of the order is in Windsor Castle, with the chapel of St. George and the chapter-house. These buildings were erected by the royal founder expressly for the accommodation of the knights of the garter.

The garter is considered the principal ensign of this order: it is worn on the left leg below the knee; it is formed of blue velvet, edged with gold: on the velvet is embroidered the motto of the order, **HONI SOIT QUI MAL Y PENSE.**

The collar is of gold, weighing thirty ounces troy weight, and contains twenty-six garters enamelled proper, in each a rose gules between; the garters are connected by knots. The George is attached to this collar: it represents St. George (the patron Saint of the order) attacking the dragon; it is of gold enamelled, and may be enriched with jewels at the pleasure of the possessor.

THE KNIGHTS OF ST. PATRICK. This illustrious Irish order was founded by George III., 1783. It consists of the sovereign, a grand master, the princes of the blood royal, and thirteen knights. The lord-lieutenant for the time being is grand master. The device on the jewel of this order is argent, a cross saltier gules surmounted with a trefoil vert, charged with three imperial crowns or, the whole inclosed in a circle of gold, bearing the motto **QUIS SEPARABIT.** **MDCCLXXXIII.** An engraving of this jewel will be found on the sinister side of the title-page.

THE KNIGHTS OF THE THISTLE. The most ancient order of the Thistle was founded by James V. of Scotland, 1540, and revived by James II., king of Great Britain, 1687, incorporated by Queen Anne, whose statutes were confirmed by George I. The order consists of the sovereign and twelve brethren or knights. Their motto is the national motto, **NEMO ME IMPUNE LACESSET**; their badge or jewel, St. Andrew, supporting a cross, surrounded with rays of gold, an engraving of which will be found on the dexter side of the title-page.

KIGHT AND BARONET. A degree of honour next to a baron, created by King James I. to induce the English gentry to settle in the province of Ulster. The title is knight and baronet; it is hereditary: the arms are distinguished by an augmentation of a



human hand gules, generally borne on an escutcheon in the centre of the shield.

NIGHT AND BARONET OF NOVA SCOTIA. A new creation during the reign of George I. to induce capitalists to settle in that part of North America. The title is hereditary: the arms are argent, St. Andrew's Cross gules surtout, an escutcheon or, with a lion rampant gules within a double tressure of the same, surmounted by a king's crown as a crest.



NIGHTS OF THE BATH. An ancient and honourable military order of knighthood. The date of its origin is too remote to be traced with certainty: by some authors it is said to have been instituted in Normandy before the Conquest; it was re-established in England by Henry IV., and revived by George I. The chapel of this order is Henry VII.'s chapel in Westminster Abbey: the Dean of Westminster for the time being is always dean of the order of the Bath. The number of the knights is according to the pleasure of the sovereign. At the close of the late war the Prince Regent, afterwards George IV., remodelled this order of knighthood; and to enable himself to bestow marks of honour upon the naval and military officers that had distinguished themselves on the ocean and in the field, he divided the order into three classes: first, all the noblemen that were Knights of the Bath were henceforth to be called Knights Grand Crosses of the Bath, which was also the title of the commanders of fleets and armies that were rewarded by being admitted into the highest class of this noble order.

The second class are called Knights Commanders of the Bath; a great number of naval and military officers above the rank of captains in the navy and majors in the army are admitted into this class.

The third class is styled Companions of the Order of the Bath, and is open to officers of inferior rank.

The Knights Grand Crosses of the Bath attach the initials K.G.C.B. to their names and titles.

The Knights Commanders use the initials K.C.B.

The Companions are known by the initials C.B.

ABEL. The noblest of abatements serving as a difference between the eldest and the junior sons. See DIFFERENCE.



ANGUED. A term derived from the French word *langue*, tongue. It signifies in Heraldry that the tongue of a bird or beast is of a different tincture from the body.

ION. The strength, courage, and majestic deportment of this noble animal, has gained him the regal titles of monarch of the forest and king of beasts. Ancient heralds selected the figure of the lion as symbolic of command, strength, power, courage, and other qualities attributed to that animal. Armorists have introduced lions to denote the attributes of majesty, might, and clemency, subduing those that resist, and sparing those that yield to authority. The lion has been depicted in every attitude which could by any means be construed into a compliment to the person the sovereign delighted to honour, by raising him to a rank that enabled him to bear arms. Was it a warrior, who, though victorious, was still engaged in struggling with the foes of his sovereign, the lion rampant was considered a proper emblem of the hero. The warrior having overcome his enemies in the field, yet retaining his military command for the safety and honour of his country, was typified by the lion statant gardant. We might easily find examples to show the propriety of the emblem for all the positions of the lion introduced as charges in coats of arms; but the two given will be sufficient: the rest may easily be imagined by the intelligent reader. The following are the most usual positions in which the lion appears in shields of arms:—

Rampant.



Rampant gardant.

Rampant regardant.



Salient.



Statant gardant.



Passant.



When the lions' heads are placed in the same position as in rampant guardant and regardant, they are then said to be passant guardant and regardant.



Sejant.

Couchant.

Dormant.

Thus far the lion is drawn in natural positions; these are considered the most honourable, as they have never been properly inserted in arms but for persons of high authority and pre-eminent courage and virtue. There are a great many deviations from the above, which are marks of great honour. It is considered that a lion cannot bear a rival in the field; therefore if two or more lions are introduced they are supposed to be lion's whelps, or in Heraldic terms lioncels.

Two lioncels addorsed or back to back.



Lioncels combatant.

Lion rampant double-headed.



An incorporated lion gardant in the fess point.



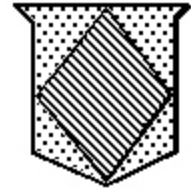
There are a great number of ways of introducing this charge: many of them will be seen under the proper words that describe their condition: such as the word *debruised*, where the lion is confined by the fess passing over it; *demi-lion* or *half lion*; but the examples here given will be sufficient to explain their positions, active or passive. If no mention is made of the tincture it is always supposed that they are proper, that is, to be coloured like nature: they are introduced in arms of every metal and tincture known in Heraldry.

ODGED. A stag sitting on the ground with its head erect, is said to be lodged.



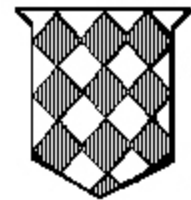
OZENGE. An angular figure, known as diamond-shaped, to distinguish it from the square.

Ex. Or, a lozenge vert.



OZENGY. Covered with lozenges.

Ex. Lozengy gules and argent.



UNA. The moon: it formerly signified argent in emblazoning the arms of sovereigns.

IANCHE. An ancient sleeve with long hangings to it.

Ex. Argent, a manche, gules.



IANED. When the manes of horses, unicorns, &c. are of a different tincture from their bodies they are said to be maned.

IANTLE. A long robe or cloak of state.

IANTLING. The flowing drapery forming the scroll-work displayed on either side of the helmet from beneath the wreath, representing the ancient covering of the helmet, used to protect it from stains or rust. When the mantling incloses the escutcheon, supporters, &c., it represents the robe of honour worn by the party whose shield it envelopes. This mantle is always described as doubled, that is, lined throughout with one of the furs, as ermine, pean, vary. For examples of mantling, see the arms and crests of England, Scotland, and Ireland.

IARQUIS. The second order of nobility in England, next in rank to a duke.

IARSHAL. A title of honour. See **EARL MARSHAL.**

O MARSHAL. To place persons in due order, according to their precedence, in public processions, such as coronations, proclamations of peace or war, funerals, &c.

IARSHALLING ARMS. The disposing of several coats of arms belonging to distinct families in the same escutcheon, together with their ornaments, parts, and appurtenances.

IARTLET. An imaginary bird said to be without legs; it is used both as a charge and a difference.

Ex. **Argent, a martlet, gules.**



IASCLE. An open lozenge-shaped figure, one of the subordinate ordinaries.

Ex. **Argent, a mascle, vert.**



EMBERED. A term used to express the beak and legs of a bird when they are of a different tincture from its body.

ERCURY. The name of the planet, used by ancient heralds to describe purple in blazoning the arms of sovereigns.

ETAL. The two metals used in Heraldry are gold and silver, called or and argent. It is against the rules of Heraldry to place metal upon metal, or colour upon colour, unless for special reasons. Therefore, if the field be of any colour, the bearing must be of one of the metals, and on the contrary, if the field be of one of the metals, the bearing must be of some colour.

ILLRIND. The iron placed in the centre of a grindstone to protect the hole in the centre from the action of the axis; it is a charge frequently borne on escutcheons of persons connected with agriculture.



Ex. **Argent, a millrind, gules.**

ITRE. A sacerdotal ornament for the head, worn by Roman Catholic archbishops and bishops on solemn occasions. Certain English abbots formerly wore mitres, and they are frequently found as charges in the arms of abbeys and monasteries. The annexed is a representation of the mitre of the archbishops and



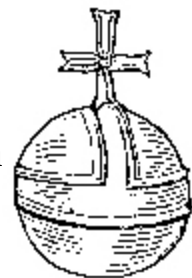
bishops of the church of England, borne as a mark of distinction over the arms of the see, or over their paternal achievements, when impaled with the arms of their see. The prelates of the Protestant Church of England never wear mitres.

The Bishops of Durham were formerly princes of the Palatinate of Durham, and wore a ducal coronet surmounted by a mitre. They still retain the coronet and mitre as an heraldic distinction, borne over the arms of the bishopric.



IORION. A steel cap or helmet formerly worn by foot soldiers below the rank of gentlemen.

IOTTO. A word or short sentence inserted in a scroll, which is generally placed beneath the escutcheon; in some instances it is placed above the crest. The motto frequently alludes to the name of the bearer of the arms, as the motto of the Right Honourable Lord Fortescue—FORTE SCUTUM SALUS DUCUM, a strong shield is the safety of commanders. Sometimes the motto is the watchword or war-cry in the battle where the original bearer won the honours that are retained by his descendants. Generally the motto is founded upon the piety, loyalty, valour, fortitude, &c. of the persons to whom arms were granted.



IOUND. A globe encircled with a band and surmounted with a cross; it is an ensign of royalty, signifying dominion.

IULLET. From the French word *molette*, the rowel of a spur: it is generally drawn with five points, as in the annexed example: when more points are used they are named.

Ex. **Azure, a mullet or.**



IURALE. A French term for walled.

IURREY. A word used by ancient armorists instead of sanguine.

AIANT. A French term for swimming. This term is used in Heraldry when a fish is drawn in an horizontal position.

Ex. **Argent, a salmon proper, naiant, its head towards the sinister side of the shield.**



AISSANT. A French word signifying coming out. It is used when a lion or any other animal appears to be rising out of the centre of an ordinary.

Ex. **Or, from the midst of a fess, gules, a lion rampant naissant.**



EBULÉ, or NEBULY. A French word, signifying cloudy, represented by a curved line, thus—



OBILITY. Under this denomination are comprehended—dukes, marquises, earls, viscounts, and barons only. Archbishops and bishops are included in the rank of clergy.

OMBRIL POINT. That part of the shield below the fess point. See page 6, letter F.

ORROY. The name of one of the Kings-at-Arms.
See King-At-Arms.

OWED. This word signifies tied or knotted, and is applied to serpents, wiverns, or any animals whose tails are twisted and enfolded like a knot.

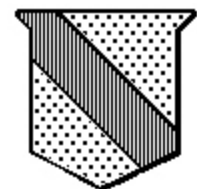
Ex. **Argent, a serpent nowed proper.**



GRESSES. Black roundlets.

R. The French word for gold. This tincture is denoted in engraving by small points.

Ex. **Or, a bend gules.**



RANGES. Roundlets tinctured tenne.

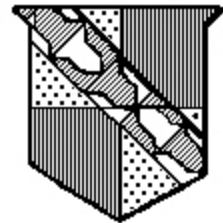
ORDINARY. A term used to denote the simple forms which were first used as heraldic distinctions, and therefore called honourable ordinaries, as conferring more honour than later inventions. They are the chief, pale, bend, bend sinister, fess, bar, chevron, cross, and cross saltier. There are thirteen subordinate ordinaries. The form, size, and place that the honourable and subordinate ordinaries occupy in an achievement are all described in the Manual, and in this Dictionary under their different names.

RLE. A subordinate ordinary composed of double lines going round the shield at some distance from its edge; it is half the width of the bordure.



VER ALL. This expression describes a figure borne over another and obscuring part of it.

Ex. Quarterly or and gules, over all a bend vair.



PALE. One of the honourable ordinaries formed by two perpendicular lines drawn from the base to the chief. The pale occupies one third of the shield.

Ex. Azure, a pale or.

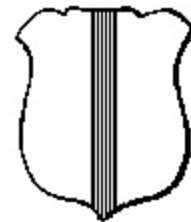


ALL. A scarf in the shape of the letter Y, forming part of the vesture of a Roman Catholic prelate. It is introduced as the principal bearing of the archbishops of Canterbury, Armagh, and Dublin.

Ex. Azure, on a pall argent, four crosses fitchy sable, in chief a cross pattee of the second.



ALLET. A diminutive of the pale.



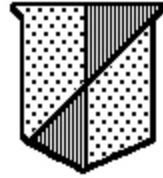
ALY. A field divided by perpendicular lines into several equal parts of metal and tincture interchangeably disposed.



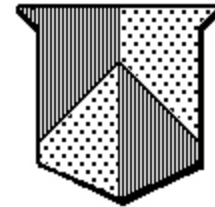
Ex. Paly of four, argent and gules.

ARTY or **PARTED** signifies divided, and applies to the several parts of an escutcheon parted by a line, which always runs in the direction of one or more of the honourable ordinaries, as may be seen in the following examples:—

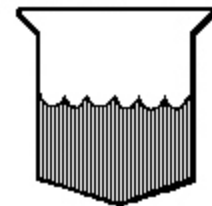
ARTED PER PALE AND PER BEND SINISTER
Counterchanged, or and gules..



ARTED PER PALE AND PER CHEVRON Gules and or,
counter changed.

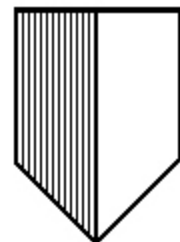


ARTY PER FESS. A shield parted in the centre by an horizontal line
through the fess point.



Ex. **Party per fess, engrailed, argent and gules.**

ARTY PER PALE. This signifies a shield parted by a perpendicular line
down the centre, so that one shield may contain two coats of arms.



Ex. **Parted per pale, gules and argent.**

ASCHAL LAMB, or HOLY LAMB.

Ex. Argent, a lamb passant, carrying a banner charged with a cross.



PASSANT. Passing or walking. See LION PASSANT and PASSANT GUARDANT.

ATONCE. See CROSS.

ATTE. A cross small in the centre, wide at the ends. See CROSS.

ATRIARCHAL CROSS. Cross used by patriarchs in the Greek church. See CROSS.

EARL. A precious stone, used by ancient heralds for argent in emblazoning the arms of peers.

EAN. The name of a fur, the field sable, the tufts or.

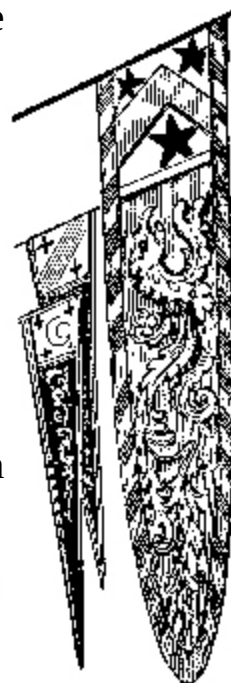
EER. Name given to all persons included in the rank of nobility.

ELLETS. A name given to black roundlets.

ENDANT. A shield suspended or hanging from a branch of a tree, or from a nail. Shields of arms frequently appear drawn thus in architecture, and when described are said to be pendant.

ENNONS. Small flags borne at the end of a lance of an esquire or gentleman bearing his paternal arms. The end of the pennon was cut off upon the person being created a knight banneret. See BANNERET. Penoncels or Pencils were small flags decorating the helmet or the horse armour. They

are now only used at funerals. The large flag in the engraving is a pennon, the smaller, penoncels or pencils.



HEON. A missile instrument with a barbed head, thrown from a cross bow.



Ex. **Argent**, a pheon proper.

PIERCED OR PERFORATED. Cut through the centre.



Ex. **Argent**, a mullet pierced, sable, on a chief azure, three mullets pierced, of the first.

PILE. An angular figure like a wedge, formed by lines running from the dexter and sinister chief to the middle base.

Ex. **Argent**, a pile, purple.

¶ **PILE.** Arms or other charges that are placed so as to form the shape of a pile are said to be borne in pile.



Ex. **Argent, three swords in pile, their points towards the base.**



LATE. One of the six roundlets; its colour is argent, but the tincture is not mentioned, as the plate is always silver.

OMEIS. Green roundlets.

OMMELLED. The pommel of the sword is the round ball or knob at the end of the hilt of a sword.

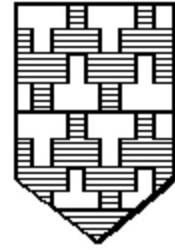


ORTCULLIS. A grating suspended by chains, used to defend the entrance to a castle.



OTENT. The ancient name of a crutch: when the field is covered with figures like small crutches it is called potent; when the heads of the crutches touch each other it is called counter potent.

Ex. **Argent and azure, potent and counter potent.** Some armorists call counter potent **vary cuppy**.



RINCE. The only Principality in Great Britain is that of Wales. The title of Prince of Wales is usually conferred upon the eldest son of the British monarch. All other sons, grandsons, brothers, uncles, and nephews, are called princes of the blood royal. For instance, the Duke of Cambridge, the uncle of Queen Victoria, is styled His Royal Highness Prince Adolphus Frederick Duke of Cambridge.

His son is styled Prince George of Cambridge.

RINCESS. Daughter of a sovereign. In England the eldest daughter of the monarch is called the Princess Royal; the others by their Christian names.

ROCLAMATION. A publication by the authority of the King. Proclamations of peace or war, or other matters of importance, are usually read by one of the heralds. They are addressed to the whole community under their different orders or ranks, viz. Clergy, Nobility, Gentry, Burgesses, and Commons.

ROPER. This word is used to denote that animals introduced as charges in an escutcheon appear in their natural colour. Modern writers on Heraldry consider this word superfluous, as the omission of the name of any metal or tincture is quite sufficient to make any person conclude that a lion, horse, or other animal is to be represented as it appears in nature.

URPURE. The colour of purple, described in engraving by lines drawn diagonally from the sinister to the dexter side of the shield.

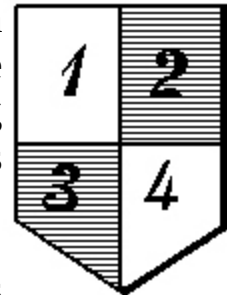


URSUIVANTS. Four officers of the Herald's College, whose duty it is to attend the King-at-Arms on public occasions, and preside over certain departments of the Herald's Office.

They are called — **Rouge Croix,
Blue Mantle,
Rouge Dragon,
Portcullis.**

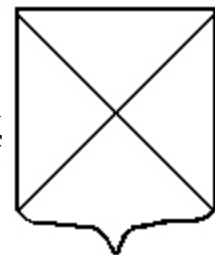
They are entitled to rank as gentlemen, but not esquires.

QUARTERED. A shield divided into four equal parts by a cross is said to be quartered. The quarter occupying the dexter chief is marked 1, or the first quarter; that occupying the sinister chief, 2; the dexter base, 3; the sinister base, 4; as in the annexed example.

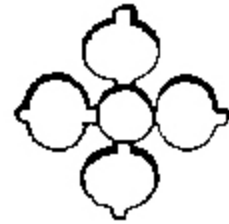


QUARTERLY. This term is used to signify that the shield is quartered. In describing the royal arms of England we should say—Quarterly, first and fourth gules, three lions passant guardant, or. Second, or, a lion rampant gules, within a double tressure of the same, flory and counter flory. Third, azure, a harp or, stringed, argent.

QUARTERED OR PARTED PER SALTIER. A field divided by diagonal lines crossing each other in the centre of the field.



QUARTER FOIL. A four-leaved flower.



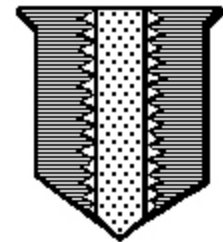
QUARTERINGS. An escutcheon divided into any number of squares is said to contain as many quarterings; they may be as numerous as the arms required. An escutcheon containing a number of quarterings is called a genealogical achievement.

QUADRATE. Square. See CROSS QUADRATE.

QUARTER PIERCED. See CROSS QUARTER PIERCED.

RADIANT. Any charge having rays or beams about it.

Ex. Azure, a pale, or, radiant.



RAGULY. Any bearing that is ragged, like the trunk or limbs of a tree lopped of its branches, is said to be raguly. See CROSS.

RAMPANT. Any beast in a fighting attitude.
See LION RAMPANT.

RAY. A stream of light proceeding from a luminous body.

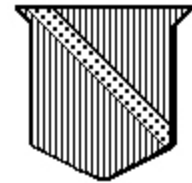
Ex. Azure, a ray of the sun issuing out of the dexter corner of the escutcheon. The lines on each side are not noticed.



EST. The figure inserted in the illustration of the word "clarion" is by some writers on Heraldry thought to represent a rest for a lance, and they give the charge that name. See **CLARION**.

EGARDANT. An animal looking towards the sinister side of the shield. See **LION REGARDANT**.

IBAND. A diminutive of the bend.



Ex. Gules, a riband, or.

OUNDLETS. Small round figures, all named from different metals and tinctures. See **p. 8**.

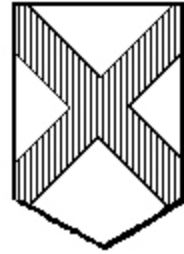
UBY. A precious stone, formerly used instead of gules.

ABLE. The term used in Heraldry for black.

ALIENT. An animal springing forward. See **LION SALIENT**.

ALTIER. One of the honourable ordinaries, by Scottish heralds called St. Andrew's Cross.

Ex. **Argent, a saltier, gules.**



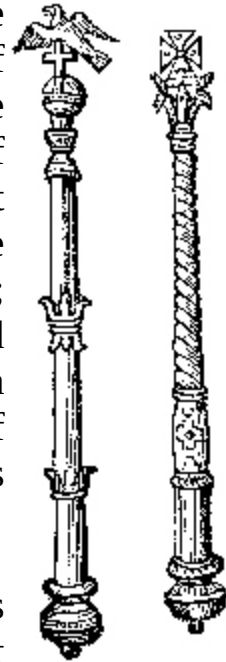
ANGUINE. One of the heraldic tinctures. It is a dark red or blood colour. By some armorists it is called murrey. The latter word is considered obsolete.

APPHIRE. The name of a precious stone, formerly used to express azure.

ARDONYX. A precious stone, formerly used to denote sanguine in emblazoning the arms of the English nobility.

ATURN. The name of a planet, used to denote sable in emblazoning the royal arms by ancient armorists.

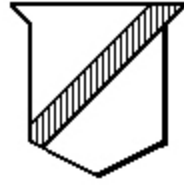
CEPTRE. A royal staff; an ensign of sovereignty borne in the hand. It was originally a javelin without a head. Sceptres of the present time are splendidly decorated with jewellery. The annexed engraving represents two sceptres of the kings of England: *the sceptre with the dove* is of gold, three feet seven inches long; the circumference of the handle is three inches, and two inches and a quarter at the end of the staff; the pomel is decorated with a fillet of table diamonds and other precious stones; the mound at the top is enriched with a band of rose diamonds; upon the mound is a small cross of Calvary, over which is a dove with its wings expanded, as the emblem of mercy.



The royal Sceptre with the Cross is of gold; the handle is plain, and the upper part wreathed; it is in length two feet nine inches, the fleur-de-lis of six leaves; the mound, and the cross above it, are richly embellished with amethysts and diamonds.

CARPE. A diminutive of the bend sinister.

Ex. **Argent, a scarpe, gules.**



CROLL. The riband below the escutcheon, on which the motto is inscribed.

EEDDED. When the seed of a rose or any other flower is of a different tint from the petal, it is called seeded. The heraldic colour of the seed in the centre of a flower is or, but, as in other proper names, the colour of the seed is not mentioned unless it is of a different tincture.



ET FOIL OR SIX FOIL. Six leaves conjoined in the centre.

EGREANT. This term is used to describe a griffin displaying its wings as if about to fly.



Ex. **A griffin rampant, segreant, gules.**

EJANT. French word for sitting. See **LION SEJANT.**

EMÉ. A French word for strewed. A field powdered or strewed with any object is said to be semé: thus a shield may be semé of fleur-de-lis, semé of hearts, &c.

INISTER. A term used in Heraldry to signify the left side of any object. Thus a bend proceeding from the top of the left side of the shield is called a

bend sinister.

LIPPED. Torn from the stock or branch.

Ex. **Azure, three laurel leaves slipped, argent.**



OL. A planet, formerly used to denote or, in emblazoning royal arms. It is the Latin name for the sun.

OL, or THE SUN IN ITS SPLENDOUR. The sun is said to be in its splendour when it is figured (that is, delineated with a human face) and surrounded with rays. Sometimes this figure is called a sun in its glory.

Ex. **Azure, a sun in its splendour.**



STANDARD. A large square flag bearing the whole of the achievements of the monarch or nobleman, as seen in the royal standard of England. The royal standard, when placed before the pavilion of the monarch either at a tourney or in an encampment, was eleven yards long and three yards broad.

The length of the standard when borne in the field denoted the rank of the leader: that of a duke was seven yards long; a peer of lower degree raised a standard five yards in length; that of a knight banneret was only four. In modern times standards of peers or knights banneret are seldom displayed but in funeral processions. The standard is then long and narrow, and

pointed at the end; that of a duke is about fifteen feet in length, peers of lower degree about twelve.

The flag borne as the ensign of a regiment of cavalry is called a standard. The flags of foot soldiers are called colours.

IAR. This celestial figure is always represented as argent, and is supposed to have six rays or points; if they have more points the number must be named. See **ETOILE**.

IATANT. An animal standing still with all its legs on the ground. See **LION** **STATANT**.

UPPORTERS are figures standing on the scroll, placed on each side of the shield as if to support it. Supporters in English Heraldry are granted only to persons included in the rank of nobility or to knights banneret by favour of the sovereign.

The origin of this addition to the external ornaments of the escutcheon may be traced to the practice which originally prevailed in the regulation of tournaments. Some days prior to the tournament taking place, each knight desirous of entering the lists was required to hang up his shield, upon which his arms were emblazoned, at the place appointed by the prince or nobleman that proclaimed the tournament, that they might be examined by the heralds, to prevent unqualified persons entering the lists. Each shield thus exhibited was guarded or supported by the servants of the knight to whom it belonged, and to disguise their livery these guardians of the shield assumed the appearance of savages, Moors, lions, griffins, and various other animals.

In after times, on the creation of a peer, the Heralds selected the supporters they deemed most appropriate, having some allusion either to the deeds, name, title, arms, or motto of the newly-created peer.

URMOUNTED. A figure or bearing having another over it.

Ex. **Gules**, a sword erect in pale, argent, surmounted by two keys, saltier, or.



URTOUT. The French word for "over all." See **ESCUTCHEON OF PRETENCE** and **OVER ALL.**

ALBOT. A dog formerly used for hunting. It is formed something between a hound and a beagle, with a large snout, and long, round, thick ears.



Ex. **Argent**, a talbot's head erased, semé of billets.

ENNE, or TAWNEY. One of the tinctures used in emblazoning arms. It signifies orange colour, and is represented in engraving by lines drawn diagonally from the sinister to the dexter side of the shield, traversed by perpendicular lines from the base to the chief.



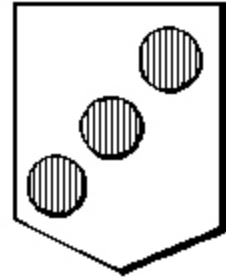
IARA. The Pope's mitre, with its triple crowns.

INCTURE. A term used in Heraldry to express colour.

OPAZ. The name of a precious stone, formerly used instead of or, in emblazoning the arms of the English nobility.

ORTEAUX. Red roundlets.

Ex. **Argent, three torteaux in bend, sinister.**



TOURNAMENTS were combats of honour, in which persons of noble birth entered the lists to gain reputation in feats of arms. The name is derived from *turner*, to turn, from the horsemen turning frequently as they rode round the enclosure, and during the course of the engagement. The design of tournaments was to train the nobility to the use of arms; none, therefore, were admitted to these sports but persons of noble birth, who could prove their descent, at least, by three generations. They were also required to be men of unspotted honour and integrity.

It was customary for princes, on some public festivity or rejoicing, to appoint a day for these entertainments, and give public notice to the knights in their own territories, as well as in the neighbouring states.

The knights generally made their appearance four days before the combat. They endeavoured to excel each other in the splendour of their equipage and dress, and in the excellence and beauty of their horses, which were adorned with the most costly caparisons. Their armorial ensigns were displayed with great pomp during three days, that all who viewed them might judge if they were worthy of entering the lists. The field where the tournament was to be held was railed in with pales. This place was called the lists. A king was appointed to preside over the sports, as were also judges to examine the knights' armour and arms, and to see that no unfair advantage was taken. A number of other officers were appointed, which our space will not allow us to mention.

A short distance from the lists were the galleries and pavilions for the spectators; the most splendid was that fitted up for the lady who presided as queen of the tournament and her attendants, all splendidly attired. The most

noble and most beautiful ladies of the court crowded to these martial entertainments to inspire the combatants with ardour, by giving them some token or favour, such as a scarf, veil, or bracelet, with which the knight adorned his helmet or spear.

Their arms were lances of light wood, without iron at the top; swords without edge or point; in some instances wooden swords were used. The knights were formed into two parties, and entered the lists by different barriers, riding round the lists several times to pay their respects to their sovereign and the ladies. At length the heralds sounded to arms; the quadrils, or troop, took their stations; when the charge was sounded, the knights rushed against each other with the utmost impetuosity. The clashing of swords, the sounding shields, the war-cry of the knights, who shouted the name of their ladye-love in the midst of the mimic strife, greatly excited the spectators, who, in return, cheered and encouraged the combatants. When the knights were brave and determined, the contest lasted some hours; the vanquished, that is, those who were thrown from their horses, withdrew from the lists as quietly as possible, leaving the field to their successful opponents. The victory was decided by the number of knights unhorsed. The prizes to the victors were adjudged and delivered by the queen and the ladies. This authority of the fair sex contributed greatly to polish the manners of the nobility and gentry of the middle ages, who were anxious to court the favour of those who were the distributors of public honours.

Sometimes this entertainment was followed by jousts. Two cavaliers, out of gallantry, would break a lance in honour of the ladies. These were followed by others until the lists were again cleared for the tournament. The difference between tournaments and jousts was, that the former were in the nature of battles, the latter of duels.

When the sports were over, the heralds and pursuivants declared the names and titles of the knights, and proclaimed the heraldic ornaments which the emperor, king, or prince that presided at the tournament granted to those whom he pleased to reward or favour.

Notwithstanding all the precautions to prevent the mischief that might happen at these martial exercises few were exhibited in which a great number were not wounded, some killed in the *melée*, others crushed by the

falling of the scaffolds, or trod to death by the horses. Kings, princes, and gallant knights from every part of Europe have perished at different times while attending or taking part in those mimic battles. Successive popes thundered out their anathemas against all that encouraged this warlike and dangerous amusement. Those who perished in these sanguinary entertainments were denied the honour of Christian burial; and yet, so strong was the passion of the nobility of Europe for these martial sports, from a desire to display their grandeur, courage, and address before the ladies and the assembled multitude, that no bulls, decretals, or anathemas of the church were able to restrain them. The use of gunpowder, and the consequent inutility of armour to defend the person in battle, gradually put an end to these animating shows. The tragical death of Henry II. of France, in 1559, who was accidentally killed in a tournament, caused laws to be passed prohibiting their being held in that kingdom. They were continued in England till the beginning of the seventeenth century.

An attempt was made to revive these martial exhibitions in Scotland, a few years ago, by Lord Eglintoun, the acknowledged leader in all manly sports, elegant athletic exercises, and baronial liberality. This noble peer proclaimed a tournament to be held at Eglintoun Castle on the 28th and 29th of August, 1839. The lists were duly prepared, a covered pavilion was erected for the accommodation of the ladies, which would contain 3000 persons. In front of this pavilion was the throne of the Queen of Beauty and her attendants. Around the lists, at convenient distances, were arranged the tents or pavilions of the knights, over which floated the gonfalon, or great banner, emblazoned with the arms and motto of the knight to whom the tent was appropriated, penons and penoncils fluttered at each angle of the pavilion, and the shield was placed over the entrance. The knights vied with each other in the decoration of their pavilions; all was in accordance with ancient customs: and if the shade of Froissart had witnessed the scene, it could not have complained of modern innovation or misplaced ornament. The procession of the King of the tournament, the Queen of Beauty, with the judges, heralds, pursuivants, halberdiers, musicians, men-at-arms, as also the splendid retinues of the noble challenger and the gallant knights, presented a scene unparalleled for magnificence and heraldic emblazonment since the days of Edward IV. Every form was observed in this modern tournament; and a more interesting scene for the historian, the

antiquary, and armorist, could not be exhibited. Unfortunately, the continued rain cast a gloom over this animated spectacle, which nevertheless excited the highest admiration of all who beheld it: a spectator of the scene could well imagine the enthusiasm similar ones would create in the minds of the gay and brave of former times. It is deemed necessary to briefly notice the last tournament held in Britain; as any one that requires full information on every part of heraldic ornament, processional arrangement, and technical definition, may find positive examples in the details of this gorgeous exhibition.

RANSPOSED. Charges or bearings placed contrary to their usual situation.

Ex. **Argent, a pile, azure, issuing from the chief between two others, transposed.**



REFOIL. Three-leaved grass: the shamrock of Ireland. When a flower or leaf is introduced as a charge in a shield of arms, if it is of its natural colour, or, in heraldic language, proper, the tincture is not named, but if of any other colour it must be described.

Ex. **Argent, three trefoils, gules, one over two.**



RESSURE. An ordinary not so broad as an orle. It generally forms a border to the inescutcheon. Tressures are frequently borne double, and sometimes

treble. They are generally ornamented flory and counter-flory. The example contains only a single tressure. The arms of Scotland exhibit an example of a double tressure flory and counter-flory, as exhibited in the shield on the [title-page](#) of this Manual. See [DOUBLE TRESSURE](#).



RICORPORATED. Three lions rampant, conjoined, under one head, guardant, in the fess points. See [LIONS](#).

RIPPING. The motion of deer, between running and walking.

Ex. **Argent, a stag proper, tripping.**



URBAND. In coats of arms, where the knight was a Crusader, this figure often appears. It was the form of the sultan's turban at that period.



URRETED. A wall or castle having small turrets. In the annexed example the square tower has circular turrets at the angles, and is therefore said to be turreted.



USKED. Any animal having tusks of a different tincture from its body is said to be tusked.

Ex. **Argent, a boar's head, erased proper, tusked gules.**

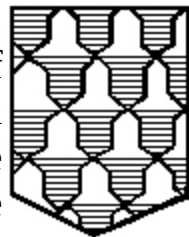


NDY. A term used to express the word wavy by Gwillim and other ancient armorists.

Ex. **Argent, a bend undy, gules.**



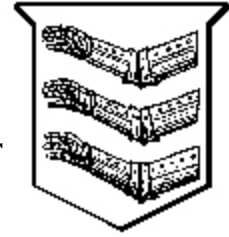
AIR. A kind of fur formerly used for the lining the garments of knights. It is represented in engraving by the figures of small bells ranged in lines, as in the annexed example. Unless the colour of the fur is named, vair is always argent and azure. The bend, the cross and saltier, are sometimes formed of this fur.



AMBRACED. Armour for the arms.

Ex. **Argent, three dexter arms, vambraced, coupé.**

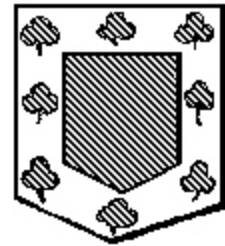
AMPLATE. A word used by ancient heralds for armour for the hand, instead of gauntlet.



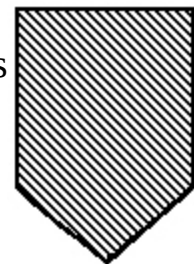
ENUS. The name of the planet, used for the colour vert by ancient heralds, who emblazoned the arms of sovereigns by planets instead of metals and colours.

ERDOY. A bordure charged with eight leaves.

Ex. **Vert, a bordure argent, verdoy, of trefoils.**



ERT. Green. It is represented in engraving by diagonal lines drawn from the dexter to the sinister side of the shield.



ISCOUNT. A title of honour, a degree below an earl.

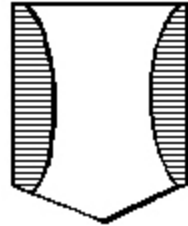
OIDED. A term applied when any part of an ordinary is left open to the field.

Ex. **Gules, a bend sinister, voided, argent.**

VOIDER. A subordinate ordinary.



Ex. **Azure, a voider, argent.**



VOLANT. The French word for flying. It is used in Heraldry to express the same action.



VORANT. Swallowing or devouring: any animal, in a charge, devouring another creature.

Ex. **Argent, a serpent crowned, or, vorant an infant.**



WOUNDED. A word that signifies wounded, used in emblazonry to denote an animal wounded by another creature.

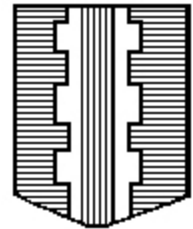
WOUNDING. Any creature in the act of wounding itself.

Ex. **Argent, a pelican's head, erased, vulning.**



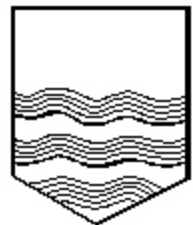
/ALLED. A term sometimes used in Heraldry. When an ordinary is edged or guarded by an embattled wall.

Ex. **Azure, on a pale, walled on each side with three battlements argent, an endorse gules.**



/AVY. Curved lines, undulating like the waves of the sea.

Ex. **Argent, the lower half of the shield three bars wavy, azure.**



/HITE. This word is only used to describe a plain fur. It is represented as argent.

/INGED. When the wings of a bird, or those of chimerical figures which are drawn with wings, are of a different tincture to their bodies, they are said to be winged. Thus, in the arms of the state of Venice there is a lion sejant guardant, winged or.

/INGS ERECT. Wings are called erect when their long feathers point upwards.



/INGS INVERTED. When the feathers point downwards.



/IVERN. A chimerical animal, the upper part resembling a dragon.

Ex. **Argent, a wivern, wings raised.**



/REATH. A chaplet of two different-coloured silks wound round each other, and placed on the top of the helmet for the crest to rest upon. In Heraldry it is usually drawn straight, as in the lower example.



CHAP. VIII.

HERALDRY IN CONNECTION WITH HISTORY, ARCHITECTURE, INTERIOR DECORATION, COSTUME, AMUSEMENT, RELIGIOUS SOLEMNITIES, FUNERAL RITES, ETC.

In the preface to this Manual, we stated that Heraldry might be considered as the symbolic history of the nobility of Britain, from the Conquest to the reign of Elizabeth. It would require a volume of far greater pretensions than this to enter fully upon the heraldic history of the peerage; but the assertion may be borne out by merely glancing at the supporters of the shields containing the arms of the British monarchs during that period.

Supporters were not introduced in English heraldry previous to the reign of Richard II. The shield of this luxurious monarch is supported on each side by an angel habited, and beneath the shield by a white hart couchant, gorged and chained or, beneath a tree. The shield of Henry IV., the founder of the Lancastrian dynasty, was supported on the dexter side by a swan, on the sinister side by an antelope, both gorged and lined or. The shield of the gallant Henry V. was supported on the dexter side by a lion rampant guardant, crowned or; on the sinister side by an antelope, gorged and chained. Henry VI. had two antelopes as supporters to his achievement. The shield of the gallant Yorkist Edward IV. is supported on the dexter side by a lion rampant argent, the tail passed between his legs, and turned over his back; on the sinister by a white hart, and in some instances by a bull. The supporters of the shield of Richard III. were two boars rampant argent, tusked and bristled or. Henry VII., as a descendant of the Welch prince Cadwallader, assumed the red dragon as the supporter of the dexter side of his shield; the sinister was supported by a greyhound argent, collared gules. The shield of Henry VIII. was supported on the dexter side by a lion guardant, crowned or; on the sinister by a dragon gules. Edward VI. had the same supporters. Mary on her marriage with Philip of Spain, empaled the arms of Spain and England as baron and femme; the dexter side of the

shield was supported by the imperial eagle, the sinister by a lion rampant, crowned or. Queen Elizabeth rescued England from this degradation; the crowned lion rampant of England resumed his place as the supporter of the dexter side of the shield, and the red dragon on the sinister. On the union of England with Scotland, the supporters of the royal arms were, on the dexter side a lion guardant, crowned or, on the sinister maned and unguled or, white unicorn, gorged and chained of the same. The supporters of the royal arms have continued the same to the present time; and, as an emblem of union and strength, long may they continue.

The reader may easily read the vicissitudes and changes of dynasty in the great change of these emblems of support and dignity during the period of time that elapsed from the reign of Richard II. to James I.; and even the brief notice here given would enable the reader to determine the date of any building if the royal arms and supporters were placed within it.

Heraldry had taken too firm a hold of the minds of the higher classes of society to escape the notice of the architects who were engaged by the sovereigns of England and by the wealthy barons, to erect those splendid ecclesiastical edifices that still exist as the architectural gems of Britain. Westminster Abbey teems with heraldic ornament, not only in the gorgeous chapel of Henry VII., but in those parts of the structure erected at a much earlier period. During the time when those styles of Gothic architecture prevailed that are now called the decorated and the perpendicular, the roof, the columns, the stained glass windows, the seats, altar, tombs, and even the flooring, were filled with emblazonment. A branch of art which our forefathers found so useful as an ornament to architecture cannot be beneath the notice of those who are desirous of treading in their footsteps.

Nor was heraldic ornament confined to architecture. It formed the grand embellishment of the interior of the palaces and baronial castles,

"The gorgeous halls which were on every side,
With rich array and costly arras dight."

The canopies of state, the furniture and plate, were all emblazoned with the arms of the royal and noble owners. And even at the present day, heraldry is far more effective for interior decoration than the unmeaning Italian scroll-

work that is substituted for it. Some idea of the value of both may be formed by glancing at the interior decoration of the new Royal Exchange; and it is to be regretted that the shields containing the arms of the different countries should not have occupied the walls, as an indication of the spot where the natives of those countries might be found; and that the compartments of the ceiling, if such ornament should be found in a building of this kind at all, should not be filled with the Italian floral scroll decoration.

In a preceding chapter of this Manual, the reader has been informed that the arms of a knight were emblazoned on the surcoat or outer garment that was worn over his armour, which was the origin of the term Coat of Arms. Heraldic emblazonment was plentifully strewed over the mantles of the nobility when they assembled on state solemnities. Nor was this ornament confined to the garments of males. Ladies delighted to appear in the cognizances of their lords, or in their own paternal bearings. Armourists that have amused themselves by treating on the curious and obsolete terms of heraldry, have supposed that the flanch and flasque represent that part of female attire which covered the body from the lower part of the neck to the waist, and that this part of the ladies' dress contained the heraldic bearing. Our contracted space will not allow our indulging in fanciful research, nor would it benefit our readers if we did so. Suffice it that we have ample proof that heraldry formed the decoration of female attire.

Numerous instances may be found, either in stained glass, monumental brasses, or illuminated genealogies, of female figures bearing heraldic devices on their apparel. A married lady or widow had her paternal arms emblazoned upon the fore part of her vest, which by ancient writers is called the kirtle, and the arms of the husband on the mantle, being the outer and the most costly garment, and therefore deemed the most honourable. This is called bearing arms kirtle and mantle.

Our **frontispiece** contains two figures kneeling, taken from *Dallaway's Heraldry*. They are to be found in an illuminated pedigree of the Weston family. The male figure is that of Sir John de Weston, of Weston-Lizars, in Staffordshire, and Isabel his wife, whose paternal name was Bromley. In three quarterfoils beneath the figures are shields: the first contains the arms

of Weston, sable, an eagle displayed or, with a lable argent, fretty gules; the centre shield is argent, fretty gules; that under the lady is her paternal arms, quarterly per fess dancette, or and gules. The figure of the knight is represented in chain armour, over which is a surcoat, on which his arms are emblazoned. The vest or kirtle of the lady is formed entirely of the colours of her arms disposed quarterly, and parted horizontally, or fessways, by the line dancette. As both the knight and his lady appear together, each bears their own arms; but if either had been drawn separately, the arms of both would have appeared on one person; if on the male, they would have been empaled baron and femme upon the surcoat; if on the female, they would have appeared on kirtle and mantle. This lady is drawn with a kirtle only.

In some of the later monumental brasses, the arms on female figures are arranged differently; the arms of the baron appearing on the outside of the mantle, hanging over the dexter shoulder, the paternal arms of the femme on the lining of the mantle turned outwards on the sinister side of the figure.

The reader will find, by referring to the word **TOURNAMENT** in the Dictionary, that Heraldry formed the great embellishment of that animated and costly amusement: and that the attainment of heraldic honours was the only means of gaining permission to join in it, and by this means only was a passport obtained to high society. These honours, which cost some trouble in gaining, could be lost by misconduct. Arms were forfeited for uncourteous demeanour, disregard of authority, falsehood, oppression, and ungentlemanly conduct; and there can be little doubt but, in a semi-barbarous age, when prowess in the field of battle was considered the highest accomplishment, that the dread of a blot on the escutcheon, or a reversal of the shield of arms, restrained many a proud baron in his tyrannical proceedings to those beneath him, and tended to keep down the insolence of the upstart favourites of royalty. Heraldry tended to soften and polish the manners, and, by the introduction of the manufacture of silken housings tapestry, and carpeting, to increase the comforts and pleasures of society, and compelled those who were anxious to exhibit the insignia of gentility, to seek distinction by other means than rapine and violence.

The term Canting Heraldry frequently occurs in ancient and modern authors. It is a term of contempt and derision, applied to symbolic bearings

that are assumed without the authority of the Heralds' College. In many cases they allude to the name or occupation of the bearer: the motto is probably a pun upon the figures contained in the shield, or some technical expression used by the parties in their agricultural or commercial pursuits.

No person, when heraldry was in its greatest repute, dared assume any cognizance or bearing without permission of the Earl Marshal or the Kings-at-Arms. Any individuals, who presumed, by assumption, to offend the laws of the court of honour, were liable to heavy fines and personal duress, which in many instances have been rigidly enforced.

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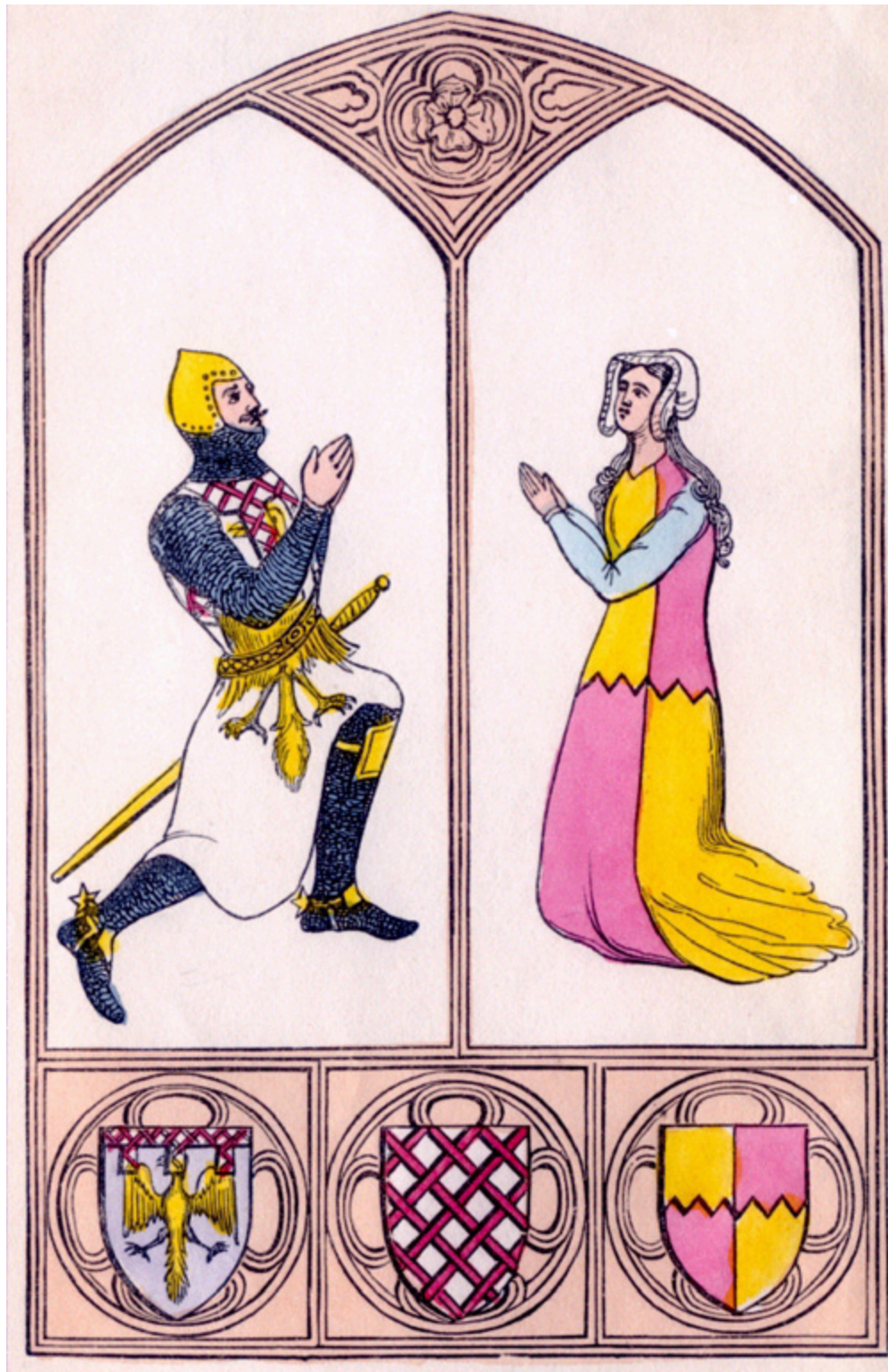
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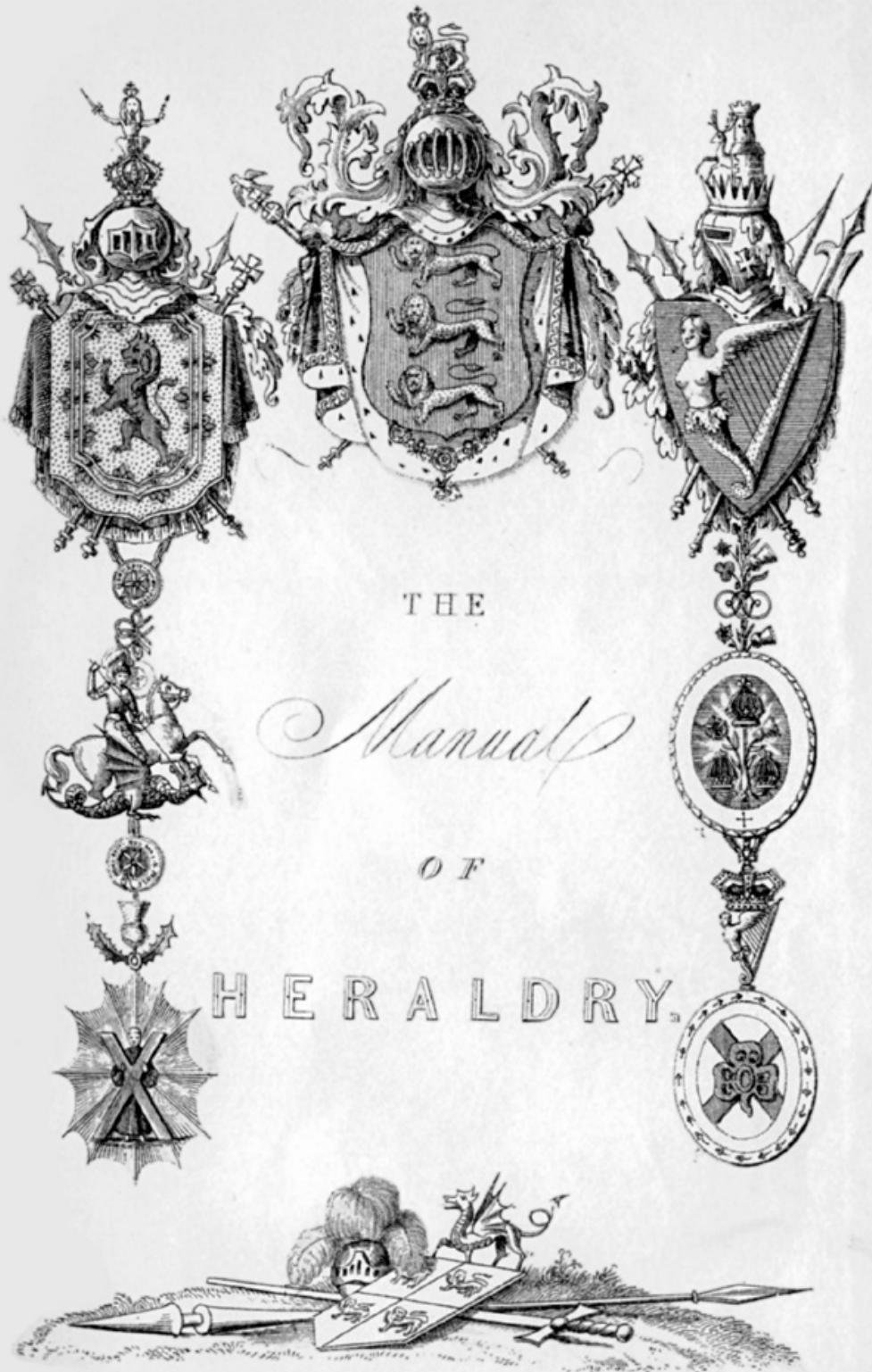
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